



PROGRESS REPORT

Digital Identity and CRVS: progress report, 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-02

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54 countries. Each row below is carried verbatim from that country's own progress report, which answers a fixed frame of indicators over the period; nothing is written here. A country not listed under an indicator has **No evidence** on it in its own report.

ROBUSTNESS OF SYSTEM · REGISTRATION OF ENTIRE POPULATION ·
NATIONAL MAINTENANCE OF ID AND CREDENTIALS SYSTEMS · AUTHENTICATION · DIGITAL ID FROM BIRTH ·
INTEROPERABILITY OF BIRTH REGISTRATION AND DIGITAL ID · USE BY OTHER SYSTEMS

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Robustness of system

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	A unified national digital identity is issued and in use as a single credential across the government services portal. Full record The credential was not on record at the window's opening. It is issued by the high commission for digitalisation and in use as a single credential across the national services portal; on 12 August 2026 the sports ministry integrated its own platforms into that portal so that holders reach them without separate registration. No enrolment count, assurance level, governing instrument or data-protection basis for the credential is held. It is running ahead of the digital-identity and trust-services law that has sat before the Assembly since November 2025, so what it legally is, and what a holder may refuse, is not established anywhere on file.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Angola	A tender opened for a US\$28m national digital identity and electronic signature platform, separate from the card, which is now generated from the birth record. Full record 2026-08-14 — the President authorised US\$28m and formally opened a public tender for a National Digital Identity and Electronic Signatures Platform, specified to support up to 30 million digital identities and to let citizens, firms and public officials use a single digital credential for public services, digital contracts, electronic verification of customers and legally valid electronic signatures. It was named as a workstream in the 2024 loan agreement with nothing built. No supplier, timetable or relationship to the separately recorded public digital infrastructure contract is stated. The physical credential is distinct and unchanged: in issue nationwide and generated from the birth record by system interoperability, on a foreign-built platform running since 2017. What moved on it is its measurement and its proposed legal monopoly, both reported elsewhere in this report.	Advanced
Benin	One presidency-attached agency owns the identity, population, civil and electoral registers as a single integrated system, issuing a card to the regional standard since 2020. Full record The identification agency opened a tender for the architecture of a business-intelligence environment over its national identity data (tender). Analytics over an identity base raises questions of purpose limitation the tender notice does not answer. A single presidency-attached agency owns identity, the population register, the civil registry and the electoral register as one integrated system, with its director general doubling as National Civil Registrar. The agency frames that as a structural decision rather than a technical one, and it has held since 2017. The card has been issued to the regional biometric standard since 2020 and remains so. Neither moved in the window, which is the point: the architecture is settled and what changed sits on top of it — issuance volumes, cross-border pilots and the services drawing on the register. The concentration is also the standing risk, and no source on this ledger records an independent audit, an oversight board or an appeal route against the agency.	Advanced
Botswana	A biometric card is itemised at P31,700,000 in the new estimates, while card replacement has been delayed since the start of 2026 on staffing and ageing equipment. Full record The labour and home affairs ministry is contending with a cartel producing fake identity documents (report). A document cartel is a statement about the credential's integrity, not only about production capacity. 2026-04-01 — the electronic identification programme was rescoped from a public-private partnership into a broader digital identity estate integrating a national wallet and electronic government services, with a biometric identity card itemised at P31,700,000, against a partnership prioritised the year before and not progressed. Against that, the physical system is failing. A parliamentary answer attributes replacement delays running since the start of 2026 to too few production staff and ageing equipment with frequent breakdowns, with no backlog figure, no restoration date and no equipment-replacement commitment. The legislative patch is in force and not working as intended: an amendment allows a passport or driving licence to serve while a card is replaced, and service providers are reported refusing even the replacement receipt.	Regressed

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Burkina Faso	A fifth-generation regional biometric card entered mass production in January 2026, issuable from age five and required from thirteen, at FCFA 3,500 with ten-year validity. Full record 2025-12-02 — the card was launched with the head of state's own enrolment and has been in mass production since January 2026, issuable from age five and required from thirteen, at FCFA 3,500 with ten-year validity, carrying both national and confederal marks, and adopted by a second member state in March 2026, against harmonised regional specifications validated by three security ministers in November 2024 with the older card still in issue. No enrolment or issuance total has ever been published, so a credential required of everyone over thirteen has no coverage figure attached at any point in its life. It is a document rather than a digital identity: the electronic identifier that would authenticate its holder against a system is reported below and is not yet enrolled.	Advanced
Burundi	The biometric identity card was presented as technically ready in May 2026 and is waiting on the law or decree governing its use, piloted in about a dozen communes. Full record 2026-05-07 — the card was presented as technically ready and awaiting the legal instrument governing its use, having been piloted in about a dozen communes. The starting position was a confirmation that it would not be ready for the 2025 voter enrolment. Whole-project cost is put at about BIF 15bn covering equipment, production centres and nationwide deployment, and BIF 16.0bn was proposed in the following year's draft budget. The order is deliberate: the government states that the data protection law came first in order to enable the card. What is still missing is the card's own instrument, an issuance figure and any statement of what it authenticates against.	Advanced
Cameroon	4,000 free cards were delivered at Yaounde 5, some to people blocked for over fifteen years by duplicate-identity records. Full record 2026-07-27 - 4,000 free cards were delivered in one district, some to recipients blocked for over fifteen years by duplicate-identity records, cleared by seconding police officers on site. The delivery was timed to public-service and police recruitment competitions, for which the card is a precondition. What it shows is a register carrying duplicate-identity records that block real people from real entitlements, and a remedy applied by posting officers to one district rather than by correcting the register. No count of blocked records, no national clearance programme and no deduplication figure has been published.	Advanced
Cape Verde	The electronic identity and authentication platform operates behind the justice portal, supporting three authentication modes. Full record The platform is operating as the state's e-identity layer behind the justice portal, supporting three authentication modes and acting as the civil-registration to identity interoperability layer that assigns a unique identification number at birth. Its stated next phase is consolidating existing databases, expanding identity-enabled services and finding long-term financing models, carrying no date, instrument or budget line. That an identity platform doing this much work has no identified long-term financing model, and no appropriation traceable to it in a digital vote that fell by seven eighths across two budgets, is the position as the base holds it.	No change

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Central African Republic	A US\$13m digital identity system was announced with an implementation window of 2027 to 2032, while police at one prefecture are reported demanding FCFA 100,000 to 200,000 for a card whose legal price is FCFA 4,500. Full record 2025-11-28 — a US\$13m integrated system built around a unique identification number, managed by a new identification office and unifying existing biometric and civil-registration databases, was announced with an implementation window of 2027 to 2032 and assessments, procurement and an international tender still ahead. It is an announcement rather than delivery, and the account reads as a project communiqué. 2026-06-16 — the existing credential moved the other way. The legal tariff of FCFA 4,500, restored by interministerial order in June 2025 after five years of overcharging, holds on paper while at one prefecture police are reported to serve one religious group first and to demand FCFA 100,000 to 200,000 from another, requiring the father's and grandfather's birth certificates. The card is the gateway document for the electoral roll and most administrative access, so the movement is in access and price rather than in technology. The second document rail is unchanged: biometric passport issuance resumed under a new operator with payment funnelled through only two banks, and no volume, price or coverage record has been held since.	Mixed, a national digital identity system announced for 2027 while access to the existing card is priced informally
Chad	The national biometric register concluded a real-time data-sharing agreement with the finance ministry, on a claim of single source of truth that is the agency's own. Full record The register launched in 2020 on a French supplier's technology, and the single-source-of-truth claim is the agency's own and is not independently verified (register, refugees, agreement). Real-time sharing with the finance ministry, in a country with no data-protection statute and no supervisory authority, is a design decision nothing on record governs.	Advanced
Comoros	A new supplier took over biometric document production on 31 March 2026, with data domiciled in the Comoros. Full record A build-operate-transfer contract had run since 2007 with all Comorian biometric data stored in Belgium and one production machine, at Moroni. 2026-03-25 - the outgoing supplier handed the biometric data to the government, and on 31 March a new supplier formally succeeded it, with data domiciled in the Comoros, production decentralised to the two other islands and a polycarbonate laser-engraved data page with a compliant chip. Production was suspended from early to late March during the handover. Contract length, value and financing source are stated nowhere in the base.	Advanced
Congo	A secure digital identity framework and wallet are named again as a roadmap foundation, with no legal instrument, wallet or pilot on file. Full record The framework was committed at a July 2025 workshop owned by the interior ministry, with a vendor cited and no legal or institutional framework adopted, the workshop's own case being that many citizens hold no valid identity document - asserted by the responsible ministry and not sized. 2026-07-28 - it was named again as one of three digital public infrastructure foundations, with still no legal instrument, no wallet and no pilot on file. Twelve months, two statements of intent and no instrument is the whole of the movement.	No change

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cote d'Ivoire	The identification office publicly named historic duplicate identities inside the biometric register; the register itself is unchanged. Full record The biometric register issued the national identification number at both ends of the window, with coverage unpublished. 2026-07-30 - the identification office's director general named historic duplicate identities inside the register publicly, and the office presented its identification work at ID4Africa in May 2026. What moved is disclosure, not the system: no deduplication programme, count of duplicates, remediation timetable or audit of the register has been published, and the statement reached the base through a commentary piece rather than an official notice.	No change, what moved in the year is disclosure rather than the register
Djibouti	A biometric national identity card has been issued nationwide since 2025, with mobile enrolment kits. Full record No biometric national identity card was on record at the window's opening. It is now issued nationwide with mobile enrolment kits, capturing fingerprints, iris, photograph and electronic signature against a national identification number held in the register of natural persons, the population directorate describing the register as the spine of a modernised and interconnected administration. No enrolment total, coverage rate or issuance figure is published at any date, so how far nationwide reaches is unestablished - and the prior-authorisation regime the Digital Code sets for national-identifier and biometric processing has no supervisory body on record to have applied it.	Advanced
DR Congo	The national digital identity platform launched on 13 June 2026, valued at US\$97.1m, with no enrolment figure published. Full record At the window's opening a twenty-year exclusive electronic know-your-customer partnership signed in June 2025 was in phased deployment with no platform live. 2026-06-13 - the platform launched at a state ceremony, valued at US\$97.1m by the planning ministry, with US\$2.6m raised by the concessionaire for initial rollout and rollout to begin with technical audits and pilot testing. No enrolment figure is published, and the financing was already unclear when the valuation was reported in January 2026. A March 2026 rollout target passed with neither launch nor delay announced before the June launch.	Advanced
Egypt	The regulator referred all four mobile operators to prosecution over lines registered without their holders' knowledge and expanded facial verification. Full record The base carries no position on mobile line registration at the window's opening. 2026-08-10 - the regulator referred all four operators to the Public Prosecution over lines registered without customers' knowledge, ordered them to halt new activations on corporate registration systems, contact every existing corporate-line holder to re-register in person by a deadline with unclaimed lines cancelled, and accelerate biometric verification, warning that non-compliance would cost them sale and activation rights. It followed reports of a nineteen-year-old sentenced in absentia to twenty-five years in a case turning on a line registered in his name. The regulator logged over 3,000 line-fraud complaints and 100,000 call-centre inquiries in two days, and public use of its line-checking service reached five million registrations in a week, roughly doubling its user base. Members asked what framework governs collection, storage and access to the facial-recognition data taken at registration, and researchers argue irreversible biometrics carry their own risk while the protection framework is still being built.	Regressed

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Eritrea	The base holds no operational foundational digital ID, a position profiled in July 2025 and untouched since. Full record 2025-07-26 — a digital identity index profile found no operational foundational identity system and set out what one would face: low connectivity and mobile penetration, thin digital infrastructure, a telecom monopoly and weak civil registration. Nothing in the twelve months to 2026-08-26 changes that. No enrolment programme, procurement, pilot or legal instrument on digital identity appears on the ledger, so the standing position is carried forward on a single profile written just before the window opened.	No change
Eswatini	Electronic identities are planned under the digital project for a 2027 rollout, and national card production resumed in February 2026 after a suspension from late September 2025. Full record Electronic identities are planned for a 2027 rollout, on a readiness report first published in 2024 (plan, readiness). Production of the existing national card was suspended in late September 2025 and resumed on 22 February 2026; the card is not a digital identity (resumption, regulation). No cause, backlog figure or remediation is published for the five-month suspension. A credential system that stopped issuing for five months, in the same period its ministry published unblurred identity documents and missed the breach-notification duty, is the base on which the 2027 electronic identity is to be built.	Mixed, electronic identity planned for 2027 while national card production was suspended for five months
Ethiopia	The programme adopted an open external assessment framework as its official monitoring instrument and re-ran it in May 2026. Full record The assessment was first run in early 2025 and re-run in May 2026, and the identity programme has adopted it as its official monitoring instrument rather than commissioning its own (assessment). The scores, findings and any remediation plan are not held, so the base records that the system is being measured and not what the measurement says. The deployment is the flagship implementation of the platform it is built on, which other national programmes take as their reference (platform account).	Advanced
Guinea	A unique personal identification number is stated to be being put in place, with no instrument, issuing authority or format on record. Full record The statement was made by the territorial administration minister at a commemorative event in August 2026, alongside digitalisation of the civil-status system, and is not an instrument (statement). The unified social register has meanwhile operated since 2019 without a unique identifier, which is the concrete cost of the number's absence (social register).	Advanced
Guinea-Bissau	A third production centre in Biombo took the national network to 18, and the ECOWAS credential reached first field issuance. Full record 2026-02-11 — the contractor Semlex opened a production centre at Safim in Biombo, its third in that region and rated at 100 cards a day, bringing the national network to 18 biometric identity production centres, with further centres planned for Sao Domingos and Bolama. 2026-03-16 — the ECOWAS biometric card was issued in the field for the first time the base records, 262 cards to women cross-border traders in Sao Domingos. Beneath both is a standing position of a functional biometric national identity card system, with Guinea-Bissau one of six ECOWAS states to have fully operationalised the regional credential. What the ledger does not hold is an enrolment total, a coverage rate, an authentication service or any legal instrument governing the system: the movement is in production capacity, not in what the credential does.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Kenya	The digital identity rollout was ruled on by the High Court in August 2024; no audit or availability figure is held. Full record A constitutional petition against the rollout of the digital identity system was ruled on by the High Court in August 2024 (ruling). The directorate responsible was renamed in 2025 and mandated to manage, maintain and operate the integrated population register (directorate). What the base does not hold on this indicator is any security audit, penetration test, availability figure, incident record or continuity plan for the identity system. The evidence available is litigation and a mandate, neither of which speaks to whether the system works under load.	No change, a ruling on the challenge with the system unchanged
Lesotho	The National Identification System is in operation, and the most recent account held of it is a case study published in 2022. Full record The system is recorded as in operation, documented in a World Bank GovTech case study of 2022 and in the same institution's service-delivery study of that year (case study, service delivery). No later coverage, enrolment or performance figure is held, and the independent research on digital identity in the country dates from 2021 (research).	No change
Libya	Enforcement in 2026 revoked 225 national identification numbers and passports and suspended 61 family records, with a trade in forged numbers still reported. Full record The attorney general's office suspended 61 family records and revoked 225 national identification numbers and passports in January 2026 (enforcement); ten further numbers were cancelled at Al-Marj the same month (cancellations). A trade in forged national numbers was still being reported in April 2026 (trade), and parliament had warned of breaches in the civil registry system in December 2025 (warning). No count of fraudulent numbers in circulation and no remediation programme is published. An independent analysis built on 66 official publications of the Attorney General's office to April 2026 found 278,969 nationality files exposed to forgery over a 43-year window, with 10,620 families and more than 4,000 individuals implicated, and named five mechanisms including direct manipulation of the registry database (analysis).	Regressed
Madagascar	The identity management system has not entered mass-enrolment production and cannot be judged robust before its commissioned audits report. Full record Terms of reference issued in March 2026 commission a two-phase technical and security audit of the national identity management system, covering architecture, security posture, scalability, resilience, continuity and incident management (terms). They state that biometric enrolment equipment is technically installed but the system has not entered mass-enrolment production, and that pre-enrolment and post-pilot audits are required before robustness can be judged. That is the whole of what the base holds on the question. No audit finding, penetration test, availability figure or incident record has been published.	No change, an audit commissioned and not yet reported

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Malawi	Offline verification authenticated more than 1.2 million farmers; the register moved to the national data centre. Full record The bureau's own plan is the base's fullest account of the architecture: biometric deduplication, public-key infrastructure and security controls, 99 per cent of adults biometrically registered, and stated resilience and integration gaps. Nothing independent tests that coverage claim. 2026-01 - the servers were relocated to the national data centre between 9 and 13 January, with identity issuance and verification paused for four days. A four-day national outage with no fallback described is a resilience fact as much as the relocation is. 2026-07 - offline code-based verification authenticated more than 1.2 million farmers, and a campaign synchronised 970,400 birth records into the central database.	Advanced
Mali	Five document categories are issued on the confederation biometric passport to international specification, under specifications validated by three security ministers. Full record The three states' security ministers validated harmonised travel and identity document specifications at Bamako in November 2024 and referred them to the heads of state (specifications, validation). The common biometric passport launched in January 2025 (launch) and five categories are now issued to international civil aviation specification on a five-year, thirty-four-page book (categories, supplier). No issuance count, rejection rate or verification figure is published.	Advanced
Mauritania	The national identity application serves about 1.5 million citizens and 554,027 remote services, and a full day of maintenance on 8 August 2026 took all of it down together. Full record The application launched in 2024 on a vendor identity platform carrying document extracts and passport requests (launch, pilot). It is in use by about 1.5 million citizens for 554,027 remote services and is the identity-verification backbone for the state services portal's fifteen-plus services and for private financial applications (usage, account). A full day of scheduled maintenance on 8 August 2026 took all of it down at once; no operator statement on the outage or on redundancy is held (outage). A single point of failure carrying that many dependent services is the finding here, and the base holds no continuity arrangement for it.	Mixed, about 1.5 million users and half a million remote services against a full day of scheduled maintenance taking every dependent service down at once
Morocco	The national digital identity application reached 2.5m users and over 7m transactions by September 2025, accelerated after attacks on three state bodies. Full record Adoption was fast-tracked after cyberattacks on the social security fund, the justice ministry and the land registry (acceleration). Usage stood at 2.5m users and more than 7m transactions since April 2022, and by February 2026 the same identity authenticates the national digital wallet (partnership). It is vendor-built on an existing identity platform, and no availability, failure or fraud measure is published for it.	Advanced
Mozambique	Updated civil identification regulations were approved in 2026 governing collection, processing and retention, and the biometric passport takes applications by electronic pre-booking. Full record The regulations under the 2022 identification law were updated and approved by the Council of Ministers, governing collection, processing, management and retention of civil identification data and standardising issuance; the instrument is not held and its provisions rest on a spokesperson's description (regulations, framework). The biometric passport is in issue with applications submitted by electronic pre-booking, named as the principal documentary-security measure at the migration service's anniversary; no dates, volumes or coverage figures are given (passport).	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Namibia	A chipped electronic identity card with a ten-year validity is confirmed for September 2026, carrying a randomly generated number for first-time applicants. Full record The card holds biometric and biographical data plus a digital identity component for remote authentication, with a thumbprint, a facial image and a personal identification number issued as on a bank card, and is valid for ten years against the indefinite lifespan of the document it replaces; a July 2026 launch was announced and slipped, cabinet approved the card in 2023, and none had been issued by August 2026 (card, announcement, validity). Identity numbers had been derived from date of birth; first-time applicants will get a random number, with legacy numbers retained on the reverse of the card and existing documents valid until withdrawn by gazette notice (number, account). The register is already load-bearing for payments, and it failed in June 2026: 15,825 old-age grants were suspended because the beneficiaries' names could not be verified against the national population registry, and pensioners were turned away at pay points before the ministry stated that those affected had either missed the notice or were dead (suspensions).	Advanced, slipped
Niger	A confederation biometric identity card entered mass enrolment in April 2026 capturing fingerprint, face, voice and iris, and a biometric passport opened enrolment in July. Full record The card is mandatory at fifteen and over, valid five years at 4,500 FCFA, and mass enrolment began on 25 April 2026 across the capital's twenty police stations (enrolment, rollout, sovereignty). The passport opened enrolment on 16 July 2026 with the president the first enrollee, five categories issued to international civil aviation specification over thirty-four pages (passport, editorial, enrolment start). Four biometric modalities on a mandatory card, with no published supervisory record from the data protection authority, is the shape a named analyst warns about.	Advanced
Nigeria	136m registrations stand against a 180m target for end-2026 with about 100m still uncaptured, and corrections are confined to a smartphone portal excluding about 72 per cent of adults. Full record Registrations passed 136m by July 2026 from 123.9m in October 2025, against a target of 180m by the end of 2026; about 100m people are still uncaptured on the information minister's own figure, and enrolment runs 56.25 per cent male to 43.75 per cent female (registrations, enrolment, count). A 2024 policy confined corrections to a device-locked smartphone self-service portal, excluding the about 72 per cent of adults without smartphones and enabling agent charges of ₦12,000 to ₦62,000 against an official ₦2,000 (corrections); validly issued numbers are also being suspended over enrolment-centre bypass with reinstatement fees pushed onto citizens (corrections, regime).	Mixed, registrations at 136m against a 180m target while corrections are confined to a portal the majority of adults cannot reach
Rwanda	The single digital identity adds iris to face and ten fingerprints, and the consent and access-log layer has no stated go-live. Full record Nationwide registration launched in August 2025 and the capture now runs iris alongside face and ten fingerprints (identity, registration, deadline). The consent and access-log layer is described as such with no go-live stated. It is the load-bearing safeguard in the design — the thing that would let a person see who has read their record — and it is the one component with no delivery evidence at all (layer, progress). A system that adds a third biometric modality faster than it adds the log of who queries it has ordered its work in a particular way, and the statutory sunset of legacy documents falls before the safeguard is evidenced.	Mixed, iris added to a three-modality biometric capture while the consent and access-log layer has no delivery evidence

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sao Tome and Principe	A foundational digital identity on an open-source platform has live prototypes for credentials, data exchange, portal and electronic signature, and no source confirms the card itself has launched. Full record A system integrator is engaged with the identity institute and the registries directorate, with prototypes live and a roadmap running January to May 2026 (pilot, mission). No source held confirms the foundational card has launched, and the roadmap's delivery is not confirmed either. The identification law that would govern it was flagged as urgent in 2025 and has not passed. So the components exist as prototypes, the statute does not exist, and whether the thing itself is issued is unestablished.	Advanced
Senegal	Identity card production resumed on 1 April 2026 after a ransomware breach forced a two-month suspension, and exfiltration is un rebutted. Full record Production was suspended on 5 February 2026 and resumed on 1 April (suspension, resumption). Exfiltration is un rebutted: the directorate's communiqués assert integrity only, never confidentiality. The volume claim appears as both 139 GB and 139 TB across one actor's two artefacts, so even the size of the loss is unestablished (breach). The data-protection law did not move through the breach, and no technical accounting has been published.	No change
Seychelles	A national digital identity platform runs a two-tier credential built on a foreign vendor's platform, and no source addresses licensing, hosting or exit terms. Full record The platform launched in September 2024 on a foreign vendor's identity platform, with the credential made mandatory for work permit holders (platform, mandate, civil status). The sovereignty question is open: no source addresses licensing, hosting or exit terms with the vendor. For a national identity credential that is the arrangement that matters most, and it is the one thing nothing published says. No enrolment count, coverage figure or authentication volume is held at any date.	No change
Sierra Leone	An open-source migration of the identity system completed pilot and is still seeking funding, while a second national digital identity platform went to private-sector consultation. Full record The migration pilot is complete and full implementation is still seeking funding (migration, identity first). A separate platform is being built with a foreign government and a foundation, and went to private-sector consultation on a trusted digital identity framework in August 2026 (consultation, dialogue, partnership). The identity agency has warned publicly against parallel identity systems, so the duplication is contested inside government rather than merely observed from outside. One route is funded and unbuilt, the other piloted and unfunded.	Mixed, an open-source migration piloted and unfunded while a second identity platform is being built and the identity agency warns against parallel systems
Somalia	A mobile identity application passed 50,000 downloads on a renewed adoption call, and a consent-based verification platform runs alongside it. Full record The adoption call was renewed in August 2026 with the application past 50,000 downloads, against about 2m registrations (adoption, application, tools). The gap between registrations and downloads is the finding: the credential is being issued considerably faster than the means of using it is being taken up. A consent-based verification platform launched alongside the application and a certificate delivery system, and nothing has entered the base about it since (verification).	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
South Africa	Every stated date moved: hosting is now 31 March 2027 and credentials 2027/28, and the digital driving licence's nearest milestone is March 2027. Full record The schedule slipped at every stated milestone. A deadline of April 2025 for cabinet approval of the legal framework was missed; the roadmap milestone of a functional digital identity by the end of the 2025 financial year was missed; the President told Parliament in February 2026 that digital identity would launch during 2026; and the department's own plan, tabled six weeks later, put hosting at 31 March 2027 and operation at 2027/28. The plan's only target for 2026/27 is the hosting infrastructure itself, with verifiable credentials via a digital wallet in 2027/28 and digital identity and e-passports by 2029. Core identity and PKI infrastructure is to be hosted within the revenue service's environment, with the central bank integrating on payments and know-your-customer checks, and facial recognition primary with fingerprints secondary. The digital driving licence moved the same way: promised for 2026, its nearest dated milestone is now March 2027. About 300,000 identity documents are blocked behind court orders where duplicates or people illegally in the country were detected, and the minister puts the great majority of identity-theft cases on the manual green identity book, still held by about 16 million people (minister).	Stalled
South Sudan	A unified national digital identity system was announced for every citizen aged 18 and over, against a base in which close to 90 per cent of the population holds no government-recognised identification. Full record The announcement came in July 2026 alongside the civil registry plan (announcement, records). Five machine systems were delivered in May 2026, two for passports and three for identity and nationality documents (machines). The production capacity is therefore arriving before the statute, the data-protection law, the register design and the fee structure that would decide who can actually use it.	Advanced
Sudan	The national digital identity has begun banking-sector linkage, and no enrolment count is held while bank accounts are conditioned on it. Full record The credential launched in May 2025 and banking-sector linkage began in August 2026, its scope publicly bounded at the same time (launch, linkage, bank data). Tying bank-account continuity to a credential whose coverage is unmeasured is the exclusion risk the base recorded before launch (trust, recovery). The electronic know-your-customer route announced by the ministry and the central bank in August 2026 is that risk being realised rather than answered: it makes the credential the condition of keeping an account current, in a country where displacement is mass and the coverage figure is still unpublished (eKYC). It has also been integrated with the trade registry (registry). No enrolment count is held at any date.	Mixed, a national credential launched and tied to bank-account continuity while its coverage is unpublished in a country of mass displacement
Tanzania	The authority published tenders for iris and facial recognition contractors for a second expansion phase, and identity card printing stays centralised after a request to print in Zanzibar was declined on security grounds. Full record Two independent parliamentary accounts agree on the expansion's scope (tenders, expansion). The government declined a request to print identity cards in Zanzibar on security grounds; passports are printed there and identity cards are not (printing). A free short-code service was launched for checking identity status by message (status). Adding iris and face to a register already connected to more than 138 institutions is an expansion of what can be matched, and no data-protection assessment for it is on file.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Tunisia	Whether issuance of the biometric card and passport has begun is not established, two and a half years after the enabling laws and past the targeted date. Full record What is missing is an interior ministry statement, an issuance figure or a gazette notice. The enabling organic laws passed in March 2024 and use was targeted for the first half of 2025; nothing held states whether issuance has begun (target, bills). Interior ministry figures for identity and travel documents issued through digital services were given in August 2026 as a ministry statement rather than a published series, with the passport figure given as several thousand without a number (figures). A biometric credential programme eight years in the making, whose issuance cannot be confirmed either way, is the gap at the centre of this unit's identity record.	No change
Uganda	28,571,893 legacy records were migrated in the platform's first brownfield migration, while the enhanced card machine-readable code does not work and has not since at least February 2026. Full record The migration completed with about 200,000 duplicates found over seven months (migration, brownfield, renewals, modules). The code failure was raised in Parliament in August 2026 and has stood since at least February with no published fix date and no count of affected cards. Parliament's own record has the registration authority acknowledging in February that the functionality had not been integrated into its digital operational system and promising a fix by 31 March (failure, codes, problems). A register data-breach investigation was opened with the protection office and police in September 2025 with no outcome, and a civil-society body demanded a fully independent inquiry (breach).	Mixed, 28.5m legacy records migrated to a new platform while the new cards' machine-readable codes do not work
Zambia	The integrated registration information system reports end-to-end automation of birth and death notification under way, and the three enrolment figures held do not reconcile — a later source carrying a lower figure than an earlier one with no revision reported. Full record A later source carrying a lower figure than an earlier one, with no revision reported by any party, is the reconciliation problem stated plainly (system, safeguards, enrolment). Procurement of an international system integrator for an open-standards identity build opened in March 2026; the card is to carry registration-card functions plus travel and private-sector service access, and delivery dates diverge between the state ICT institute and the Registrar General (procurement, training, advance). Two agencies giving different delivery dates for one credential is worth recording as the coordination question it is.	No change
Zimbabwe	A national digital identity was announced in May 2025 for a July 2025 start with no start recorded, and every claim about it in the base is relayed second-hand. Full record No start is recorded and every claim is second-hand (identity, denial). Population registry modernisation began around 2023; the registrar-general states personnel are trained and materials in place, and no independent confirmation is held (modernisation). A digital identity announced fifteen months ago for a start that never happened, evidenced only at second hand, is the position — in a unit that has a licensing regime for data controllers and a certification fee for their officers.	Stalled

Registration of entire population

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Angola	The census put card coverage at 52.4% of those aged five and over, leaving 14.9m undocumented, against a universalisation plan now printing in all 21 provinces. Full record 2025-11-26 — the first national coverage figure the base holds puts 52.4% of the population aged five and over as holding the card, 63% urban against 30.9% rural, leaving 14.9m people undocumented, drawn from the 2024 census definitive results. Before it, a 2023 diagnostic said only that the country was far from universal coverage. The movement is in measurement rather than in coverage. Issuance capacity did move. A universalisation programme runs printing posts in all 21 provincial capitals with two to three printers per province planned, mobile brigades in remote municipalities and three phases covering unregistered adults, cards at birth and replacement of degraded documents; one provincial campaign issued and delivered more than 4,000 cards in 16 days in a single municipality, and the ministry has been opening identification posts through the year. Collection is the leak. More than 120,000 issued cards were awaiting collection at identification posts nationwide in July 2026, the first such figure held and with no prior series to read it against.	Advanced, on issuance capacity, with coverage measured for the first time rather than raised
Benin	Biometric enrolment stands at about 98-99% with 7.7m identification numbers issued, while a charity issued 130,000 free cards and found dead enrolment numbers. Full record The 2017 identification law created the agency and a unique personal identifier reaching about 10m people in six months; a World Bank-supported programme added 2.2m more, lifting biometric enrolment to about 98-99%, with 7.7m personal identification numbers and 6.1m certificates issued free, the system being described as increasing access to services. The gap between enrolment and a card in hand is what the window exposed. 2026-05-18 — a non-governmental organisation issued more than 130,000 free cards across nine communes in eight months on an electoral-participation rationale, and in doing so found failed fingerprints and dead enrolment numbers left by the earlier campaign. So near-universal enrolment and incomplete issuance sit together, and the defect was surfaced by a charity doing the state's distribution rather than by the agency's own reporting.	Advanced, in issuance rather than in coverage
Botswana	The Omang register operates under a 1986 statute; an electronic identity card was piloted and remains at feasibility. Full record 1986-12-24 — the National Registration Act establishes the register, its contents and the registration requirement. 2025-11-25 — a feasibility study supported by the African Development Bank and a pilot of electronic identity card production were announced in Parliament. No coverage figure — how many of the eligible population hold an Omang — is published, which is the figure this indicator turns on.	No change, with an electronic product still at feasibility

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Burkina Faso	A decree organising mass enrolment for the unique electronic identifier was adopted on 30 July 2026, run entirely by public structures so biometric data stays sovereign. Full record Enrolment for the regional alliance's common biometric identity card opened at Arbinda (report). 2026-07-30 — a vendor was recruited and a decree adopted organising mass registration through national, regional, provincial and communal committees run entirely by public structures, so that fingerprint and iris data stay sovereign, with mass enrolment targeted before end-2026, under the regional identity programme. The starting position was a 2024 framework law in force with awareness workshops running, no vendor and no enrolment, the 2025 tender having failed. The decree states no enrolment target, budget or supervisory authority, and its gazetted text is not held. Running enrolment through public committees rather than a contractor is a deliberate sovereignty choice and it is also an unpriced one. The critical-infrastructure classification decree was adopted at the same sitting, which means the instrument that will have to cover mass biometric enrolment arrived the same day the enrolment did.	Advanced
Burundi	83.5 per cent of under-fives were registered at the last national survey; thirteen communes now hold a biometric registration system. Full record The third demographic and health survey puts 83.5 per cent of children under five registered with the civil-status authority, 83.7 per cent of boys and 83.3 per cent of girls, reported against the sustainable development goal indicator. It is the primary national statistical publication of the figure and it is now nine years old. 2026-08-10 — the territorial administration directorate set out digitalisation of civil status in pilot communes with decentralisation to zone level, and a UN agency stated that thirteen communes already have a biometric registration system. What has not been published is any updated national coverage rate, so the base can date the machinery and not the population it has reached.	Advanced
Cameroon	A second production centre opened at Garoua in August 2025, running at about 2,000 cards a day. Full record Issuance ran from a single production centre at the window's opening, the new card having entered issuance in March 2025. 2025-08-07 - a second centre opened at Garoua at about 2,000 cards a day, with a displacement-response enrolment track. No enrolment total, coverage rate or backlog figure has been published at either end, so production capacity is the only measure of registration the base holds - and capacity is not coverage.	Advanced
Cape Verde	The national identification card keeps its 2014 legal basis and 2018 launch design, now produced domestically and renewable online. Full record The card is a polycarbonate contact smart card created by decree in 2014, with fee regime, biometric capture rules and validity period set by later instruments, its chip carrying identification, authentication and digital-signature applications, officially launched in January 2018. Same design and legal basis, now renewable online through the justice portal and produced domestically. No issuance total, coverage rate or holder count is held from any date, so how much of the population carries it is unestablished - which the birth-registration figure recorded elsewhere in this report should not be read as answering.	No change

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Comoros	The personal identification number's technical, legal and institutional framework was validated at a Moroni workshop. Full record The number was provided for by the law of 27 July 2023 with nothing on record being built. 2026-03 - preparatory studies were validated at a Moroni workshop and the framework agreed, the number designated the cornerstone of citizen identity with interoperability to other state systems specified. No issuance date, coverage target or numbering scheme is published. A cornerstone identifier validated on paper, in a country whose civil-registry agency exists in law and not in fact, is as far as the identity layer has reached.	Advanced
Congo	Production of the biometric unique-identifier card was relaunched, after a proximity distribution campaign for uncollected cards. Full record Production was halted at the window's opening, with 10,506 identity cards and 25,549 number cards uncollected in one city alone, prompting a proximity distribution campaign. 2025-10 - production was relaunched. The prior suspension is inferred from the word relaunch: no suspension date, cause or duration is on file, and no national coverage or issuance figure exists at either end of the window, so what moved is production capacity rather than any measured count of people registered.	Advanced
Cote d'Ivoire	The regional identification project's enrolment figures did not move, and the residence-card exchange has gone unreported since 2017. Full record Health-insurance enrolment under the regional identification project stands at about 60%, on a status report archived in May 2025 that nothing later has replaced. The biometric residence card for foreign nationals has been issued since 14 August 2017, storing fingerprints and facial images, with holders of non-biometric cards required to exchange them. Nothing on file since 2017 reports issuance volumes or completion of that exchange. No registration rate, coverage figure or enrolment series for the population as a whole is published by any Ivorian body.	No change
Djibouti	A biometric identity card is issued nationwide against a register whose enrolment total has never been published. Full record The statutory basis stands: the register of natural persons is the unique reference for identifying individuals and producing every secure national document, with the identification number assigned from birth and compulsory across public, parapublic and private administration. The card built on it is issued nationwide with mobile enrolment kits where none was on record when the period opened. No enrolment total, coverage rate or issuance figure is published at any date, so how much of the population is registered is not established. The 2024 census counted the population but is a different exercise from registration.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
DR Congo	The identification office held its first board meeting and adopted a roadmap to accelerate registration (roadmap). Full record The national identification office held its first board meeting on 20-21 August 2026 and adopted a roadmap to accelerate population identification (roadmap). A roadmap is not enrolment: the base holds no registration figure against it. At the window's opening a card-production partner was under discussion with no start date and no financing route. 2026-05-29 - the office announced the start of operations as imminent with the partner withheld, the 2026 finance law giving national-identification acquisition FC 20,654,178 and revised provisions sitting in a supplementary budget before the Assembly. The last national identification was in 1984. The electoral file was formally handed to the identification office in February 2026, and no enrolment or card-issuance figure is held at either end - so what has moved is the financing route, not the count of people identified. 2026-08-17 - separately, forty agents finished training at Gbadolite for a provincial operation identifying Mbororo herders, on a digital collection tool and a questionnaire validated by an interministerial commission recording identity, ties to the country, weapons and cattle. No legal basis, retention rule or data controller is stated for it.	Advanced
Egypt	Electronic registration of births and deaths is stated as taken nationwide, and civil-registry kiosks stand at sixteen locations. Full record The base carries no statement on electronic civil registration coverage at the window's opening. The health ministry and associated bodies are stated to have taken electronic registration of births and deaths nationwide, credited with faster and more accurate demographic monitoring. Nationwide is the plan's own word: no coverage rate, completeness figure or target date is reported, the plan document is not held, and the claim is uncorroborated. The sixteen mall-based kiosks across six governorates and the airport, issuing birth, death, marriage and divorce certificates and identity application forms on fingerprint or facial verification and paid in cash, are unchanged, with no expansion, transaction count or withdrawal recorded.	Advanced
Equatorial Guinea	The biometric identity document is issued from a central agency, with a 2025 national tour reporting 7,670 dossiers obtained and 7,275 processed. Full record Issuance takes about 30 days for the identity document and 14 to 17 days for a passport, and the tour figures remain the most recent held (tour, agency). The executive has invited parents to register children and adults over 18 to obtain the document (invitation). There is no digital identity: the World Bank diagnostic records a 2018 digital civil-registry pilot only and recommends building one, and nothing has been built since (diagnostic).	No change
Eritrea	With no foundational system in service, no share of the population is registered into one, and nothing in the window changes that. Full record The same 2025-07-26 profile that finds no operational foundational identity system names weak civil registration among the barriers a future one would face, which is the nearest the base comes to a statement about coverage. No enrolment figure exists to report, because there is nothing to enrol into. The population counting the base does hold is the survey work reported under Censuses and surveys, which is a statistical exercise and not a register.	No change

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Eswatini	Birth registration completeness reached 61 per cent in 2025 and death registration 62 per cent, against 8.3 and 26.5 per cent in 2016. Full record The 2022 annual vital statistics report put completeness at 35.6 per cent of births and 55 per cent of deaths (report). The 2025 figures announced at the ninth Africa civil registration day are 61 per cent of births and 62 per cent of deaths, against 8.3 and 26.5 per cent in 2016 (commemoration). The 2025 report itself is not held as a downloadable government publication. The population register is a compulsory register of every birth, marriage and death since 1984, and is a paper-based statute not shown to be digitised. The 2027 census is the next whole-population count, with household mapping begun and E130.5 million allocated. Two in five births are still unregistered.	Advanced
Ethiopia	Enrolment reached 49.1m by August 2026 from 16.4m in June 2025, on 12,000 registration kits, against a 90m target. Full record Enrolments stood at 49.1m on 24 August 2026, from about 46.5m in July and 16.4m in June 2025, on 12,000 biometric registration kits deployed nationally (enrolment count). The incumbent operator accounts for 69% of all registrations, about 32m people since April 2024, of which 20.19m in the year to June 2026, with 9.35m cards printed against about 9.4m ordered (operator channel). The second operator took two lots of the registration project in July 2026, covering Afar, Amhara, Tigray, Sidama and three southern regions (registration lots), and a four-lot procurement of about US\$54m for registration super agents awaits the lender's clearance (aide-memoire).	Advanced
Gabon	335,384 people have enrolled for the electronic identity card since June 2024, with 147,224 cards collected and 78,500 files disputed. Full record The first public coverage figures were given to the National Assembly on 2 June 2026: 335,384 enrolled, 164,944 cards produced, 147,224 collected, 92,614 files in processing and 78,500 disputed (enrolment figures). Issuance launched on 24 June 2024 (launch) with no enrolment figure on the record and the project indicator still at a zero baseline (project indicator). The disputed files are about 23 per cent of all enrolments (disputed files), and the count rests on press accounts of a spoken answer; no registry or ministry publication exists.	Advanced
Gambia	A national identity system went live in July 2026 and nationwide rollout of ten-year biometric cards began on 7 August at six centres. Full record Field reporting from biometric identity enrolment centres in the Greater Banjul Area found high demand meeting daily processing caps (reporting). The base holds no enrolment total. The system issues instant cards from the national data centre, and the cards are produced with a Ghana-based supplier; no enrolment or issuance figure has been published since launch (rollout, launch). It runs under an eight-year design-build-finance-operate-transfer contract signed in January 2026, with a 70/30 revenue share, ten-year card validity, free replacement of valid cards and a second-phase data centre; no contract value is published in anything held (contract, terms). The arrangement it replaced was a foreign concession the government had resolved to end, so the country moved from a concession to a build-operate-transfer contract rather than to direct state issuance.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Ghana	19.2m people aged 15 and over are registered with 262 institutions integrated, and enrolment of 3.1m children aged 6 to 14 resumed in May 2026. Full record A backlog of 640,000 cards was cleared and distributed by September 2025, with instant issuance nationwide and eleven overseas missions (registration); the institutions-integrated count moved from 95 in September 2025 to 262 in early 2026 (registration, backlog cleared). Child enrolment resumed on 5 May 2026 against a target of 3.1m, phased at 21 days per region and run jointly with the health insurance authority (child enrolment, biometric verification). A paid tier has operated around the clock on three shifts at an Accra centre since 1 August 2026, which the agency states is optional and does not replace its 276 district offices; no throughput, staffing or fee schedule is published, and there is no equivalent extension of the free daytime service (paid centre, 24-hour centre).	Advanced
Guinea	Biometric enrolment opened in one commune in March 2026 on a first phase of 2,000 certificates, after the predecessor project closed with about 8,000 identities. Full record The earlier foundational project closed on 28 June 2024, two years early, having issued about 8,000 unique identities (closure). Enrolment for biometric birth certificates and national identity opened in Sanoyah commune as phase one (enrolment). Issuance was decreed free in February 2025, and the state contractor alleged in July 2026 that unprovided-for fees and pay-for-priority were being taken at enrolment centres, with no ministerial response on file (fees alleged).	Advanced
Kenya	More than 42m identity records were digitised in FY2025/26, with enrolment extended to dependants aged 7 to 17. Full record KSh 15.13bn was committed in FY2024/25 for 7.5m cards and unique personal identifier rollout, and first-time fees were scrapped in March 2025 (commitment, fees scrapped); no dated series of cards issued, applicants enrolled or backlog is held (digitisation). The population management vote holds near its supplementary peak at KSh 10,993.0m for FY2026/27, against KSh 8,085.6m in the prior year's original estimates (vote, prior year). Government is procuring a system to cut card issuance to ten days and passports to a week, on a headline-only source with no contract, vendor or value held (procurement). Application charges for the identity card were scrapped and the KSh1,000 replacement fee waived for six months by gazette under the Registration of Persons (Amendment) Rules 2025, and the interior cabinet secretary said in June 2026 that a digital Maisha Card carried on a phone would follow. Against that, an analyst compilation puts 2.3 million adults without a card, 80.5 per cent of them aged 18 to 25 - the exclusion concentrating on the adults most often asked to prove identity to enter formal work or finance. No official count of the unregistered is published.	Advanced
Lesotho	The identity register covered roughly 85% of the eligible population in 2022; no later figure is published. Full record 2022-05 — an assessment put coverage at an estimated 85 per cent of the eligible population, a little over a million people of a total 1.2 million. 2026-02-26 — a 2026 commitment was made to an integrated digital identity ecosystem. 2026-06-29 — a modernisation framework consultation opened at the home affairs ministry. The coverage figure is four years old and both movements since are about the platform rather than enrolment. No later count is published.	No change, on a four-year-old coverage figure

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Liberia	Mass enrolment has been suspended since June 2025 on coverage below 15 per cent, with a concession to enrol all 5.3m people now before Parliament. Full record The identification registry is seeking US\$39m to replace its technology and open identification centres across the country, where applicants' biometric and personal data would be captured and cards printed the same day (report). The money is sought, not secured. The concession is with an Austrian firm to finance enrolment in 18 months, operate and transfer; consultations have concluded and the draft agreement has gone to Parliament, with selection and terms unpublished until legislative approval completes and the registry stating it will disclose the agreement only after ratification (concession, firm, restart). About 740,000 had enrolled by the end of 2024 at a US\$5 card fee, and about 640,000 prior registrants were locked out with issuance halted (lockout); no updated enrolment figure has been published (lockout, funding gap). Enrolment has been mandatory for citizens and 90-day residents since April 2025 under an executive order making the identification number the primary credential for banking, health, education and telecoms (order, no identity, no transaction). So a mandatory credential has been unobtainable for more than a year, on a register the state cannot afford to run and is now handing to a concessionaire.	Advanced
Libya	Holders of administrative rather than national numbers remain outside services gated on the national number, with no published resolution. Full record Protests were reported in June 2025 by holders of administrative numbers excluded from services that require a national identification number (protests). No resolution has been published since, and the base holds no registration coverage figure: no count of the population holding a national number, and no count of those in the administrative category.	No change
Madagascar	The first adult enrolment phase registered more than six million people against a two-million target, on 2,500 kits across 1,729 centres. Full record A steering committee validated the proof of concept and released 2,500 kits across 1,729 centres operating six days a week (kits); the January pilot had enrolled about 130,000 people across 116 centres in 26 communes (kits, pilot, enrolment). More than six million adults were enrolled in the April to June 2026 phase, against a two-million target, with a second phase in preparation (phase, identity). The counts are reported on different scopes and dates, from 2.6m in two months to over 5.6m in total (counts, review), and no cost figure for either phase is reported. The pilot ran through regime change, civil unrest and a cyclone.	Advanced
Malawi	Over 13.5m adults hold a national digital identity, about 99 per cent of those aged 16 and over, up from 12.5m a year earlier. Full record The registration system has been in operation since the National Registration Act came into force in 2015, with 12.5m enrolled and links to over 33 public and private institutions recorded in May 2025 (system). The count reached over 12.8m adult identities in January 2026 (intermediate) and over 13.5m by July, about 99 per cent of the eligible population, with over 150,000 enrolled between April and June 2026 of whom 53 per cent were women (coverage, baseline). It is the highest identity coverage in this pass, and the registry's own figure is preferred over external accounts describing coverage as already complete.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mali	The confederation biometric identity card was piloted on Malian soil in June 2026 for another member state's residents, with no Malian enrolment figure published. Full record The cross-border diaspora enrolment pilot ran in Bamako in June 2026, enrolling Burkinabe residents rather than Malian citizens (pilot). No Malian enrolment figure, coverage share or rollout date is published, so the country's first biometric identity card operation on record served somebody else's population.	Advanced
Mauritania	The population register reached 5.1m entries against 3.4m in 2019, with enrolment now a permanent public service, and a contested residual without papers. Full record Figures given to deputies in June 2026 put 5.1m on the register against 3.4m in 2019, with more than 1.7m new enrolments, over 613,000 people captured by a difficulties survey and 238 local commissions installed (register); enrolment is now a permanent public service under the 2025 reform (register). More than 94 per cent of the population had been reported enrolled since 2020 (coverage). A contested residual of citizens without papers falls disproportionately on two population groups and sits in tension with the aggregate coverage claim, which is why the difficulties survey exists.	Advanced
Morocco	4.6m electronic identity cards were issued in 2024, including 219,408 for citizens abroad through seventy-one centres at diplomatic missions. Full record The police directorate's annual report gives 4.6m cards issued during 2024, with 219,408 issued to citizens abroad through 71 centres at diplomatic missions (annual report). No 2025 or 2026 issuance count is held (institutional account), and no coverage share of the adult population is published, so the base holds a flow figure and not a stock one.	No change, the newest issuance figure is for calendar 2024
Mozambique	856,101 identity cards were produced in the first half of 2026, up from 730,527, of which 297,470 were issued free. Full record Production ran at 856,101 cards on 813,307 applications in the first half of 2026, against 730,527 on 677,305 applications a year earlier (production); the figures are the directorate spokesperson's with no published series behind them (production). Free first issuance of the identity card, birth certificate and personal certificate was extended to 2027 and widened to children and adults alike, with 297,470 free cards issued in the first half of 2026 (extension); neither the 2027 end month nor the deadline replaced is stated (extension).	Advanced
Namibia	117,175 identity documents were issued in 2025, and 40,238 of 166,237 printed were left uncollected over fifteen months. Full record The minister gave 117,175 national identity documents, 126,737 birth certificates and 682 refugee cards issued in 2025 (issuance); the 2024 comparator held in the base is a campaign count rather than an annual series (issuance, budget). Between April 2025 and June 2026, 166,237 documents were printed, 125,999 collected and 40,238 left uncollected, about a quarter of the print run (uncollected). A school-based drive reached 24 of 55 target schools by July 2026, with officials returning to each school to hand printed documents to learners rather than requiring a ministry visit; documentary requirements are unchanged, which the source names as the residual barrier for learners with incomplete birth registration (drive).	Mixed, a school-based registration drive running while about a quarter of printed documents go uncollected

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Niger	The universal identification programme was restructured onto the statutory register stack with a goal of 22m enrolled, above a pilot of more than 3,000 in four communes. Full record The programme was operational with a goal of 22m enrolled by 2026 and has been restructured to carry the statutory register stack, with enrolment starting in the capital (programme, pilot). An open-source identity pilot enrolled more than 3,000 people across four communes, with no later enrolment figure published (open source). The gap between the 22m target and the pilot is the whole of the country's enrolment evidence: no national enrolment count under the restructured programme is published.	Advanced
Nigeria	A ward-level drive opened free enrolment across all 8,809 wards, against a 22.3-point gender gap in who holds an identity number. Full record Free enrolment runs in every ward across the 774 local government areas, targeting women, children, elderly people, persons with disabilities and refugees (drive, progress). Women are 38.8 per cent of enrolled holders against 61.1 per cent men, a 22.3-point gap (gap); in one state twenty-one centres serve about 7.5m people, a ₦3,000 round trip is prohibitive, no number means no access to the maternal-care fund, and rural women's phone ownership is 42 per cent against 78 urban (gap). The drive is aimed squarely at that gap and no post-drive gender figure is published.	Advanced
Rwanda	More than 8m people were registered by August 2026 against a June 2027 hard deadline, and registration and photographing are separate counts whose gap is unexplained. Full record More than 8m registrations were reported in August 2026, with biometric enrolment accelerating through the year (enrolment, acceleration, progress). Registration and photographing are separate counts and the gap between them is not explained, which matters because the June 2027 deadline is statutory rather than administrative: on that date legacy documents cease to be valid whether or not the gap has closed. The national identification appropriation outturned at 140.7 per cent of its allocation in 2024/25 and was appropriated again for 2026/27 (appropriation); it is the digital line the fisc actually funds, against the flat data-protection line and the 11.5 per cent cyber-skills execution (appropriation, prior).	Advanced
Sao Tome and Principe	A free national identity card campaign ran in phases including an islet and a diaspora arm, with cards collectable at the embassy in Portugal. Full record The campaign ran to an outlying islet in January 2026 and extended to the diaspora, with cards collectable at the embassy in Portugal by June (campaign, diaspora, embassy). Free issuance and physical collection at an embassy are the two access designs that matter most in a small island state with a large diaspora, and both are recorded here. No issuance count, coverage figure or campaign end date is published.	Advanced
Sierra Leone	The identity agency reported about 93 per cent population coverage, and registration, card issuance and coverage are three different metrics kept apart in the record. Full record Coverage was reported to a digital public infrastructure consultation in August 2026 and has not moved in the base since a 2025 statement of the same figure (coverage, services, opportunity). Card issuance is tracked separately because registration, issuance and coverage measure different things and conflating them would overstate what a person actually holds (issuance). An ethnographic study documents human intermediation in enrolment — brokers standing between the citizen and the register — reported as analysis rather than as a state position (brokers).	No change

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Somalia	About 2m people were registered for the national identity credential by April 2026, against an estimated 19.7m population of whom about 85 per cent held no legal identity at the 2022 survey. Full record Registration passed one million in November 2025 and reached about 2m by April 2026, under a mass registration drive launched in September 2025 (registration, million, drive). At the 2022 household survey about 85 per cent of an estimated 19.7m population held no legal identity and fewer than 16 per cent a government one (survey), so the base against which this is progress is very low. Two member states have not adopted the national system, one operating its own identification authority, so the register is federal in name and partial in territory (member states, centre).	Advanced
South Africa	Smart identity services ran at 410 bank branches by 13 August 2026, with 574,371 applications processed through banks, against 30 branches a year earlier. Full record 2026-08-21 — a departmental reply to Parliament put 410 bank branches live as at 13 August 2026 and 574,371 applications processed through banks, against 30 branches across five banks in August 2025. The department commits to at least 200 more and states a possibility of 750 branches during 2026/27, and separately to modernising 75 of the 145 remaining unmodernised local offices this financial year. A public branch locator is published. 2026-01-28 — issuance itself set a record: 4,002,964 smart identity documents in 2025, up 17%. The branch counts do not form a series — 372 and 408 appear a week apart in August before the 410 in the reply — and the 750 is a possibility stated to Parliament rather than a target. This is the largest measurable delivery in the twelve months, and it is a channel expansion rather than a new system.	Advanced
South Sudan	School-based national identity registration was launched for examination candidates, against a nationality certificate held by about 10 per cent of the population. Full record Registration was launched at a secondary school in August 2026 with expansion to more schools planned, following card collections in one region (school, collection, issuance). The stated fee is over 50,000 South Sudanese pounds (school). About 10 per cent of the population holds a nationality certificate (certificate); stock held and cards issued are reported on different bases across sources and no single reconciled coverage figure exists (certificate). A personal identity card required for banking, land transactions and court processes stood at 380,000 held by the directorate in January 2026 (card). A fee at that level, on those coverage figures, is the access question this unit does not address.	Advanced
Tanzania	Digital acquisition of identification numbers and cards is under development, aimed at rural access (report). Full record Measures are under development to let citizens obtain identification numbers and cards digitally, aimed at rural access (report). The base holds no enrolment figure against it. The coverage figures run to December 2025 in an annual financial-inclusion report (coverage, usage). Issuance and distribution are stated separately in the same report; the bases differ between personalised, issued and distributed, both counts rose and the gap did not close (issuance). At the window's start the base held only a deadline to deactivate the numbers of people who never collected cards, with no count (uncollected). A one-year window opened for more than 14,000 dismissed public servants to correct records and obtain cards, closing inside the next reporting year (window).	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Togo	More than six million unique identification numbers and biometric cards were reported at end-December 2025, a rounded floor rather than a precise count. Full record Enrolment campaigns ran region by region through 2025 and 2026, and enrolled, number issued and card delivered are one counter because the card is handed over at the campaign (numbers, platform, campaign, phase). The figure comes from the government's own second-half 2025 reform-implementation report, which is not held (count). That the three stages collapse into one counter is unusually clean for this frame — most units in it report enrolment and issuance separately and cannot reconcile them.	Advanced
Uganda	Over 60 per cent of printed cards are uncollected, and the auditor general recorded a backlog whose figures were ten months old at publication with no current series published. Full record The identification authority holds 36.15 million people on the national register, close to 77% of the population (figure). The mass exercise closed in February 2026 with over 60 per cent of printed cards uncollected (printed, renewals). The auditor's figures are as at late October 2025 and are reported alongside cross-district queue chaos over new-card collection; the authority publishes no current backlog series (backlog). First-time enrolment against target and renewal ran at two different rates, and the two rates are the finding: efficient for people already on the register (enrolment). A further mass drive was stated to Parliament with no start date, budget or delivery plan on record (drive).	Advanced
Zambia	Biometric enrolment runs against a funded baseline of 1,500,000 people with digitally verifiable identity at December 2022 and a 4,000,000 target at October 2030, and card issuance was deferred until after the August 2026 election. Full record The enrolment figure was given by the ministry to the state broadcaster (enrolment, safeguards, switch). Biometric card issuance was deferred to after the general election (deferral). A nationwide mobile campaign for 3.5m identity documents launched for a three-month run in April 2025, and its result is the largest single unreported outcome in the pre-window base (campaign). The paper card has been in issue since before independence, on the appraisal document's own wording rather than a published commencement date (paper card).	Mixed, biometric enrolment progressing against a 2030 target while card issuance was deferred past the election
Zimbabwe	A 2022 mobile civil registration exercise issued 3,203,389 documents, and the home affairs minister said he was not aware of any identity-document backlog and was hearing of it for the first time. Full record The 2022 exercise ran February to September and was reported to Parliament by the home affairs minister (exercise). The backlog measure is set against that minister's denial in the Senate; he said he was not aware of any backlog and was hearing of it for the first time (backlog). A donor-funded mobile registration drive ran for five days in a remote district in July 2025 with no count of documents issued held (drive), and birth registration coverage is dated to the 2023-24 demographic and health survey rather than to the articles reporting it (coverage).	Mixed, three million documents issued in a 2022 mobile exercise while the responsible minister says he is unaware of any backlog

National maintenance of id and credentials systems

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	The police signed a biometrics and digital-forensics memorandum with a foreign interior ministry in November 2025. Full record Nothing of the kind was on record at the window's opening. 2025-11-21 - a memorandum was signed covering fingerprint-analysis training and biometric identity-verification exchange. No value, duration, workplan or data-handling arrangement is stated for it. Biometric identity-verification exchange between two states' police forces, in a country whose data-protection authority has issued no enforcement decision and whose deliberations take effect on its own website, has no published safeguard attached.	Advanced
Angola	Card printing moved from a single national centre to all 21 provinces from 1 July 2026, on a platform built abroad since 2017. Full record 2026-07-01 — all 21 provinces began printing the identity card locally, with two to three printers per province planned and a 24-to-48-hour issuance target; one province reports issuance under 24 hours against one to two weeks before, and the same decentralisation reached the exclave province in July. This is printing only: enrolment and biometric capture are untouched. Underneath it, the card has been issued on a foreign-built platform since 2017, and the digital identity platform now out to tender is also to be procured rather than built. No source states who maintains either system, what the support arrangements are, or whether source code or operational control sits with the State — which is the question this indicator asks and the record does not answer.	Advanced, on printing capacity, with the platform itself foreign-built
Botswana	P108,505,050 was sought in 2026/27 for Omang card production and the registration systems' maintenance. Full record 2026-02-24 — the ministry requested P108,505,050 to cover, among other things, the production of national identity cards and the maintenance of the birth and death registration and identification systems. No supplier, contract value or maintenance arrangement is separately published, and the base holds no statement of where the systems are maintained or who holds the source code.	No change, funded annually and unchanged in form
Burundi	Travel-document production is stated to be assured entirely by ministry staff since a foreign supplier's contract expired. Full record The interior ministry records that travel-document production is assured one hundred per cent by the migration directorate's own staff since the expiry of the contract with a foreign supplier, a new supplier providing consumables only. It is the clearest official statement on this ledger that a credential system is nationally operated rather than vendor-run, and it is the ministry's own. What it does not carry is a volume, a backlog figure or any statement about the identity card as distinct from the passport — so the claim covers travel documents and cannot be extended to the credential estate as a whole.	No change
Cameroon	The card is produced under a fifteen-year build-operate-transfer contract signed in May 2024, with a FCFA 10,000 pre-enrolment fee. Full record The credential is produced under a fifteen-year build-operate-transfer contract signed in May 2024, with a pre-enrolment fee of FCFA 10,000, and nothing in the window changed that arrangement. The same pattern runs through the consular credential, issued under a ten-year build-operate-transfer contract signed in April 2022. No transfer milestone, revenue share, performance standard or exit arrangement is published for either, so what the state will own at the end of fifteen years is not stated anywhere on file.	No change

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cape Verde	Production of identity documents moved onto national territory on 18 May 2026, from a foreign state printer. Full record Production and personalisation of the identity card, electronic passport and foreigners' residence permit were contracted to a foreign state printer, with over CVE 176 million ratified after the services had been supplied - the expenditure ran behind the spend, not ahead of it. 2026-05-18 - production went live on national territory, with over 1,000 identity cards, the first residence permit and about 50 passports produced by 10 June, against installed capacity of 1,200 cards, 1,200 permits and 2,400 passports a day and annual demand of roughly 80,000, 5,000 and 60,000. Project investment is estimated at CVE 400-500 million.	Advanced
Comoros	The card is instituted by loi n 14-023/AU and produced under a concession whose supplier changed in 2026. Full record The justice ministry's index carries the promulgating decree for the law instituting the digital, biometric identity card, which is the first record of a statutory basis in the base. The system is maintained by a supplier, not by the state. Production runs under a build-operate-transfer concession, whose new holder domiciles the data in the Comoros, decentralises production to the two other islands and issues a polycarbonate laser-engraved data page with a compliant chip; production was suspended for most of March 2026 during the handover. No contract length, value, renewal cycle, issuance figure or service-level obligation is stated anywhere on file, so what happens at the end of the concession is not knowable from the base.	No change, a statute now on file and still no maintenance regime, renewal cycle or issuance figure
Cote d'Ivoire	The population identification line was voted identically for FY2026 at FCFA 8,791,576,615, the largest single named digital line in the budget. Full record The FY2026 finance law voted FCFA 8,791,576,615 for population identification, the same figure as FY2025 and up from FCFA 5,000,000,000 in FY2024. It is the largest single named digital line in the Ivorian state budget, and it is domestically financed. No outturn is published for either year, and nothing states what the line buys - enrolment, card production, register operation or system maintenance are not separated. A flat vote across two years is consistent with a system in steady operation and equally with one not being invested in.	No change
Djibouti	The mobile identity service is run by the Interior Ministry with four domestic bodies, on a register the state maintains by law. Full record The founding law assigns administrative management of the register to the population directorate and technical and security management to the state information-systems agency - the credential system is maintained in-country by statute, not by contract. 2026-02-10 - the mobile identity system was launched by the Interior Ministry with the digital economy ministry, the network operator, the cybersecurity authority and the state information-systems agency, the biometric data held only by the Interior Ministry. No maintenance contract, vendor arrangement or key-management rule is published, so what the state runs itself and what it buys is not established from the record.	Advanced
DR Congo	Identification is run under a twenty-year exclusive partnership while the state appropriated FC 20,654,178 for it. Full record The identity platform operates under a twenty-year exclusive partnership signed in June 2025, and the state's own appropriation for national identification acquisition in the enacted 2026 finance law is FC 20,654,178 - a figure that cross-foots exactly against its group total and is not a transcription error. It corroborates the identification office's own account that the allocation obliged recourse to a partnership. No transfer milestone, revenue share, performance standard, exit arrangement or data-custody rule is published for the twenty-year concession, and no state body is named as holding the register at its end.	No change, the identity layer runs on a twenty-year exclusive concession while the domestic appropriation for identification is negligible

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Eswatini	Identity card production resumed in February 2026 after a suspension for technical upgrades, and in August the ministry asked citizens to verify the chief code on their documents. Full record Production resumed at ten service centres in February 2026 after a pause for technical upgrades, with a plan to clear the resulting backlog (resumption). In August 2026 the ministry asked citizens to check that the chief code on their identity documents matches their actual chiefdom, warning that an incorrect code creates difficulty in reaching government services, and describing how corrections are made in the civil registration system (campaign). The statutory basis is the Identification Order of 1998, which establishes the population register and the personal identity number (Order). The card does not meet the criteria for digital identification. No issuance figure, backlog size or correction count is published at any date.	Mixed, production restored after a suspension while a campaign asks citizens to correct the records themselves
Ethiopia	The identity programme was incorporated as a state-owned enterprise in August 2026 under the sovereign wealth fund, and plans to widen its wallet. Full record The programme was commercialised into the sovereign wealth fund with a 10bn birr cap in March 2026 (wealth fund), then incorporated as a state-owned enterprise on 4 August 2026 with the programme's executive director appointed chief executive (enterprise). The holding company states the purpose as attracting partnerships and creating long-term value, and positions the enterprise for export (the same account). The wallet is planned to carry academic transcripts, professional licences, healthcare records, property titles and compliance data beyond the government credentials it holds today, with no timetable, consent model, controller arrangement or regulatory approval stated (wallet expansion).	Advanced
Gabon	The national directorate enrols, personalises and issues in-house at its own facility, with a foreign supplier providing the card and the software. Full record The supplier's own annual review lists the card and passport among its delivered solutions, and it is the only primary on the question (supplier review). The directorate personalises in-house alongside the passport and the residence permit, which is what reporting means when it describes the card as produced domestically; the two layers are compatible and were once read as three competing suppliers. No procurement notice, award publication or gazette entry is held, so the supply arrangement is established by the supplier's own publication and by no Gabonese public record.	Advanced
Kenya	600 live capture devices were procured and issuance reported at ten days, on a statute dating from 1947. Full record The Registration of Persons Act, assented in December 1947 and commenced in 1949, remains the statute providing for registration and the issue of identity cards (act). 600 digital live capture devices were procured, with new identity cards reported issued in ten days (procurement), and administration officers trained on the revised registration system (training). An anti-corruption commission opened talks in August 2025 on integrating its systems with the population register (integration). The ten-day issuance figure is the ministry's own.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Lesotho	A 2026 work plan with UNICEF commits to a MOSIP-based national identity platform covering passport and identity renewal and proof-of-life verification. Full record The work plan was signed by the ministry and UNICEF on 3 March 2026, covering passport and identity renewal, biometric registration and proof-of-life verification on a MOSIP base (work plan). Digital identity pilots had begun under the memorandum with India, with no platform then named (memorandum), and the systems under development were reviewed with the national university in February 2026 (review). No procurement, vendor or go-live date is published.	Advanced
Madagascar	The institution responsible has existed since 2020; an audit firm for the identity system was sought in March 2026. Full record A decree of December 2020 created the national civil status and identity centre, responsible for maintaining, securing and operating the national registers and the unique identifier under the interior ministry (decree). An expression-of-interest notice of March 2026 recruited a firm for the identity system's performance audit, evidence the system remained under active project-led review (notice). Infrastructure equipment for the data centres that host it was tendered in three lots in February 2026 (tender). Maintenance to date has run through a donor project that closed in June 2026; no successor operating budget is held.	Advanced
Malawi	About two million expired cards had their validity extended to 1 January 2027 rather than being replaced on time. Full record Maintenance is a statutory duty: the National Registration Act 2010 assigns upkeep of the register to the Director and district registrars and prescribes the renewal, replacement and correction of credentials. No service standard or performance figure is published against it. 2025-12 - the bureau extended the validity of roughly two million expired national identity cards to 1 January 2027 while it renews, prints and distributes replacements. No renewal throughput or completion forecast accompanies it. 2026-01 - the servers were relocated to the national data centre, pausing issuance and verification for four days. The infrastructure was maintained; the credentials on the ground were deferred.	Mixed, a two-million-card renewal backlog met with an extension while the register itself moved house
Mali	A national agency for civil status document security was created in 2025, and passport supply moved from a French to a Chinese vendor in October 2025. Full record The agency was created in 2025 with no output figure published (agency). The passport supplier changed from Idemia of France to Emptech of China in October 2025, a change officials cast as regained sovereignty and local data management (supplier). Neither move puts the credential's production in national hands: what the base records is a domestic body responsible for security and a foreign body responsible for supply.	Mixed, a national agency created for document security while passport supply moved from one foreign vendor to another
Mauritania	The transport minister stated in August 2026 that driving licences and registration plates would be issued in biometric form before the end of 2026. Full record The statement came alongside continued reform of the land transport directorate (statement). It is a stated target with no procurement, supplier or system specification published, and it is the only credential besides the national identity card and the passport that the country has committed to issuing biometrically.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mauritius	The omnibus bill would make permits issuable in digital, card or paper form and impose a digital travel authorisation on visa-exempt arrivals. Full record The authorisation would be applied for electronically and paid before travel; the bill was introduced and not enacted (provision). It is the first credential in the base whose form is set by statute rather than by the issuing agency, which is what makes the digital form enforceable rather than optional.	Advanced
Morocco	A biometric passport decree approved in July 2026 abolishes temporary passports and removes the address, and identity-card renewal moved online. Full record The decree specifies four languages including Amazigh, an encrypted chip, the address removed from the biodata page and temporary passports abolished, with the current format continuing during a transitional period; the joint body that sets issuance procedures is not yet in place (decree, account). Identity-card renewal moved online in mid-2026 with pre-fill, document upload, residency-certificate tracking and stamp-fee payment, biometric capture remaining in person; no take-up figure is held (renewal, announcement).	Advanced
Mozambique	8,790,034 identity cards had been issued, about 31.4 per cent of the population, from 208 service posts, and a national mobile digital identity and electronic signature layer went out to expressions of interest. Full record 2026-05-29 — the digital transformation agency issued a request for expressions of interest to design and implement a national mobile digital identity and electronic signature layer, integrated with the interoperability platform, the national population registry and the national public-key infrastructure. It is the clearest step in the window toward a maintained identity and credentials layer, and it is at procurement, not deployment. The system it would sit on is thin. The civil identification directorate's own account puts issuance at 8,790,034 identity cards to date, about 31.4 per cent of the population, across 208 service posts and 14 diplomatic missions, with a production centre rated at 15,000 cards a day, and names operationalising the link between the identification and civil-registration systems among its own outstanding challenges. A press rated at 15,000 cards a day against coverage of 31.4 per cent is not a capacity problem, which points the question at demand, distribution and cost rather than at production.	Advanced, a mobile identity layer entered procurement over a card system covering under a third of the population
Namibia	The electronic identity is free at the point of issue for first-time applicants, renewals, amendments and error replacements, with a first duplicate at N\$150. Full record A first duplicate costs N\$150 and a second N\$300 (fees); the schedule was stated by ministry officials at Gobabis and on a regional awareness tour (fees, expiry). Free issue with a charge only for duplicates is the arrangement most likely to move the uncollected-document figure, and no fee for the card's digital component is separately stated.	Advanced
Niger	An identification agency was created by decree in April 2026, while the card and passport are produced by a Libyan supplier with a local partner. Full record The agency was created and chartered under the interior ministry with its statutes approved by a companion decree; no budget, staffing or enrolment target is stated and no gazetted text of either instrument is held (agency, restructuring). Two memoranda were signed with the supplier in June 2025 and it now produces both the card and the passport with a local partner, a change officials cast as technological independence and local data control (memoranda, modernisation). Independence from one foreign supplier achieved by contracting another is the tension the cell records rather than resolves.	Mixed, a national registration agency created by decree while the card and the passport are produced by a foreign supplier

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Nigeria	A multipurpose biometric card is in development with the payments switch, a cooperative identity credential is in revalidation, and border management is being biometrically strengthened. Full record The three-in-one biometric card with multiple wallets is in development with the payments switch and the domestic card scheme, for agency services, student loans and farmer inputs (card, memorandum). A six-month revalidation exercise is under way to issue cooperatives a verification number and their members an identity credential under a memorandum with a private identity supplier; no cooperative or member count, cost, or link to the foundational register is stated (cooperatives). Border management is being strengthened through digital technology, biometric identity systems and intelligence sharing, on a statement at a forum rather than a procurement, with no system, vendor, cost or data-protection arrangement for the biometric collection stated (borders).	Advanced
Sao Tome and Principe	A passport issuance system was launched in April 2026 under a four-year contract with a foreign state mint. Full record The system launched under a four-year contract with another country's national printing and minting house (system). The predecessor system's status is not established in anything held, so what changed is unstated. Passport personalisation held under contract with a foreign state institution is a sovereignty arrangement the record states and does not examine.	Advanced
Somalia	Cabinet approved a third-generation electronic passport plan on 6 August 2026, having been cleared to adopt a regional passport standard in February. Full record The cabinet approval came in August 2026 (plan), after clearance in February to adopt and print the regional bloc's electronic passport (clearance) and a stated overhaul target the previous September (overhaul). No cost, supplier, issuance target or personalisation site is published, and nothing states whether the passport draws on the national identity register.	Advanced
South Africa	Third-party use of the population register was priced from July 2025 at R10 a verification, with the revenue earmarked for the system's maintenance. Full record 2025-06-23 — a price was gazetted for third-party use of the population register: R10 per real-time verification and R1 per batch field, free to state departments, municipalities and statutory bodies, in force 1 July 2025, the department describing it as correcting unsustainable under-pricing of a service it has run since 2013 and earmarking the revenue for the system's maintenance. That is the only funded maintenance arrangement for an identity system on this ledger, and it is unusual in kind: the system is maintained out of what banks and other private verifiers pay to query it. No maintenance spend, uptime figure or upgrade programme is published against that revenue.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
South Sudan	Passport stock and clearance figures were given at a directorate handover, and a new-generation passport is announced for August 2027 on a validity change with no amending instrument on file. Full record The stock and clearance claims are the outgoing officeholder's own, made at his own handover; the annual applicant figure and a month-long delay are the incoming officeholder's (handover, testimony, booklets, resumption). The new-generation and regional passport is announced for August 2027; ten-year validity would require amending the passport act, the handover was reported as having extended adult validity already, and no amending instrument is on file while the directorate's own account puts the change before the Assembly (passport, roadmap). A validity change reported as done and simultaneously as pending is the same unreadable-instrument problem the gazette entry describes.	Advanced
Uganda	Iris hardware was deployed on more than 5,665 registration kits, the authority establishment was expanded, and the system contract is single-sourced with no value, award date or term held. Full record The iris deployment covers the 2024 to 2026 campaign; the registry figures are vendor-sourced and two roughly one-million populations are distinct and must not be summed (iris, unmatched). The establishment expansion was stated in plenary in August 2026; it is an establishment figure rather than a filled-post figure, with no recruitment timetable or wage provision stated (establishment, support). The contract behind the migration is single-sourced with no contract value, award date or term held, and it is the whole of that relationship in this base (contract).	Advanced
Zambia	The registration department began computerising card, passport and citizenship-document issuance, financed through a US\$100 million programme. Full record 2025-08 – the home affairs permanent secretary announced that the registration department has begun computerising national registration card, passport and citizenship-document issuance in collaboration with the state technology institute, targeting online applications including from the diaspora. 2025-09 – a US\$100 million digital acceleration programme was approved, the financing vehicle for the new identity and civil registration system. What the base cannot yet say is who will run it. Both accounts describe a build financed externally and integrated by a vendor to be selected; no statement of in-house operating capacity, staffing or vendor exit arrangement is held.	Advanced
Zimbabwe	Electronic passport enrolment runs in ten districts, eight provincial centres and one abroad, and civil registration office computerisation bounds a decentralisation model three other states said they would copy. Full record The passport figures were stated by a deputy registrar general at a registrars' meeting (passport). The sub-office computerisation ratio bounds the decentralisation model three other states said they would copy, which is what makes the ratio worth stating (computerisation). A donor-funded programme to digitise and solarise civil registry sub-offices launched in August 2026 with no value, timetable, district list or birth-registration baseline against which to measure its effect (sub-offices, digitisation).	Advanced

Authentication

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	The certification and governmental signature authorities were designated in 2025, modernising the 2015 framework. Full record Both authorities were designated by February 2025 and the regulator's authentication and electronic-signature service was set out in September 2025, modernising the 2015 electronic-signature framework. Nothing moved after that. No certificate count, relying-party list or usage figure is published, and the trust-services law that would put the arrangement on a current statutory footing is still before the Assembly - so the country's signature layer runs on a 2015 framework with two designations on top of it.	No change
Angola	Parliament granted legislative authorisation for an electronic signature and certification regime, and a public key infrastructure was contracted ahead of it. Full record 2026-07-30 — parliament unanimously approved legislative authorisation to the President, valid 90 days after publication of the enabling law, for a regime defining an accrediting authority, a root certification entity and the evidential weight of an electronic signature, grounded on the insufficiency of two 2011 instruments. The substantive text will be an executive instrument and is not yet made. The technology is ahead of the law. A public key and time-stamp infrastructure was announced as a ministerial intention in June 2025 with nothing contracted and no legal basis; it is now contracted as a component of the US\$150m public digital infrastructure project, and the tax authority is already running mandatory electronic invoicing on it in practice. The trust layer is being built ahead of the law that would govern it.	Advanced
Benin	The national root certification authority and trust services entered operation on 1 July 2026, having been established a year earlier without operating. Full record The national root certification authority and its trust services were established in July 2025 and not yet operating; 2026-07-01 — they are recorded as operating. That closes a twelve-month gap between an instrument and a service, and it is the trust layer under the exchange, the diaspora passport platform and the certificate issuance reported elsewhere in this report. No certificate volume, accredited provider list or evidential rule is published, so what a signature issued under it is worth in a Beninese court is not established on this record.	Advanced
Botswana	The public key infrastructure is funded, begun, incomplete and non-operational, with P423m secured and control transferred to the intelligence directorate. Full record 2026-07-30 — the public accounts committee was told the project is funded, begun, incomplete and non-operational: P423m secured, control transferred to the intelligence directorate, no working system, no timeline and no accountable owner. The ministry's own headline figure appears as both P420m and P423m in the single account. The consequence is stated plainly in the same source: the country has no certificate-backed identity verification and no recognised electronic-signature layer. That is the missing floor under everything else in this report. The services portal, the payslip portal, the rescoped digital identity and the regional know-your-customer framework all assume a trust layer that P423m has not produced.	Stalled

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Burundi	A border system reads and verifies passports at the international airport against international police databases, the first authentication on the ledger. Full record 2025-08 — a border management system was launched at the international airport, automating reading and verification of passports with a direct interconnection to international police databases, announced for progressive extension to other border posts. It is the first instance on this ledger of a credential being checked against anything rather than simply read. What it authenticates against is a foreign database, not a Burundian one. The domestic position is that national identity is presented as documentary evidence rather than authenticated against a register, and no extension of the border system beyond the airport is recorded.	Advanced, one border post
Cape Verde	The mobile authentication credential keeps its 2020 legal basis and 2022 implementing rules; no activation count is held. Full record The credential was created by legislative decree in 2020 with implementing rules set by a 2022 portaria, a permanent PIN plus a one-time code, obtainable in the phase described only by first activating the identity card's digital functions. No activation count and no coverage rate is held from any date. The restriction binding the credential to prior card activation is undated on the government page and may no longer hold, so even the enrolment route is not established - for the instrument on which remote access to every service behind the identity platform depends.	No change
Comoros	No authentication service is on file; the card's new data page carries a compliant chip and nothing reads it. Full record The one comparative study in the base is the World Bank's identification systems report, whose Comoros brief describes the biometric enrolment and authentication mechanism; the capture holds the front matter and table of contents and not that brief, so what the mechanism is cannot be read from the base. What is held is the credential. The concession's new data page is polycarbonate, laser-engraved and carries a compliant chip, with the biometric data now domiciled in the country. No verification service, application interface, relying party or transaction count appears anywhere on file. A chip nothing queries is a security feature, not an authentication system.	No change, the identification report the base holds does not carry its Comoros brief
Cote d'Ivoire	One bank was integrated for real-time identity checks against the national register under a convention signed in November 2025. Full record At the window's opening no commercial institution was integrated with the register. 2025-11-11 - a convention was signed integrating one bank for real-time identity checks against the national register. No second bank appears on file, no pricing is stated, and no volume of checks has been published. Nothing states the legal basis on which a commercial party queries the register, what a customer may refuse, or how a failed match is handled - which matters more here than the count, because the same route is being extended to lenders and social-protection targeting elsewhere in this report.	Advanced
Djibouti	A mobile digital identity platform entered service on 9 February 2026, carrying authentication and electronic signature. Full record The platform did not exist at the window's opening. 2026-02-09 - it was launched at a national digital identity forum, in service for authentication and electronic signature, with biometric data held only by the Interior Ministry, reported across the trade press and in the biometrics press. Interoperability with driving-licence and health records is stated as planned rather than delivered. No activation count, service count or transaction figure has been published since launch, so what the credential is used for is unknown.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Egypt	The national digital identity app reached a second release adding biometric verification and liveness detection, integrated with e-signature and e-seal. Full record A digital identity card enabling remote verification was under development. The app is now released and in its second version, integrated with electronic signature and seal services, with civil-registry-linked verification stated as approaching. No registration count, first-release date or governing decree is held. Signature and seal services are live using the security token and integrated with digital identity, with remote signature stated as expanding across government services and the digital post box being finalised. 2026-02 - an interior ministry Android pilot has users scan the identity card and complete facial recognition to authenticate for selected government services, with scaling to be decided on the pilot's outcome; it was described at launch as the country's first unified biometric authentication platform, which is hard to reconcile with the central bank's own system three months earlier.	Advanced
Eswatini	The central bank is standing up a national electronic know-your-customer registry to digitise identity verification. Full record The registry was reported in September 2025 (registry). No go-live, participant count or governing instrument is published. It would be the country's first authentication layer, and it is being built by the central bank rather than by the identity or ICT authorities — so the first working identity verification in the state may sit inside the financial regulator.	Advanced
Ethiopia	194m identity verifications have been performed across 150 integrated agencies, and biometric kits have gone to banks. Full record The programme reports 194m electronic know-your-customer verifications to date across 150 integrated agencies, on its own unaudited figures (verification count). Two thousand portable face, fingerprint and iris kits were distributed to 31 banks in November 2025 of 6,000 planned, at about US\$17m, with the remaining 4,000 under a re-issued tender (biometric kits). No authentication failure rate, exception-handling procedure or availability figure is published.	Advanced
Ghana	Biometric-only verification is law from June 2026, and a fresh SIM re-registration announced for early 2026 has still not started. Full record The amendment regulations bar visual inspection and photocopying and make biometric verification the only lawful check (regulations). The SIM drive was announced for the first quarter of 2026 with liveness detection and 80 per cent self-service specified, and no start date is on file (re-registration); the 2021 to 2023 registration has been declared invalid and the 2022 biometrics confirmed never authenticated against the identity database (re-registration, never authenticated). The legislative instrument that would carry it was stated ready to be laid on 5 December 2025, has not been laid, and its first-quarter start date passed with a later-in-2026 rollout restated in February (instrument).	Mixed, biometric-only verification became law while the biometric SIM drive it depends on has not begun
Kenya	Talks opened with a foreign secure-identity provider on a platform letting citizens reach public and private services on one digital identity. Full record Both sides agreed to deepen technical and policy collaboration towards an interoperable identity architecture under ministry-wide governance; no contract, procurement, value or timetable is stated (talks). A verifiable-credential wallet proof of concept was completed for the public service commission after an audit found over 2,000 fake certificates, with no single credential database and no production decision or funding on file (proof of concept).	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Lesotho	A digital service-ID pilot of about 10,000 participants began in April 2026, requiring a national identity document, a registered SIM and biometric registration. Full record The pilot was announced on 25 March 2026 to begin on 2 April with about 10,000 participants in a testing phase (pilot). Registration requires a valid national identity document, a registered SIM card and biometric registration. No vendor, legal basis or evaluation criteria is stated, and no result from the pilot has been published.	Advanced
Libya	The Level 3 biometric tier of the national digital identity entered technical trials with the central bank and several banks in April 2026. Full record The identity authority and the Central Bank of Libya put the biometric tier into technical trials with several banks in April 2026, ahead of its use in banking know-your-customer checks (trials). The system is named the Digital Identity Management System for Citizens in that release and LY-DNID in the July one, and no enrolment count, authentication volume or assurance standard is published for either name (July release).	Advanced
Madagascar	The biometric card's authentication module was specified in June 2025 and its pilot validated for nationwide deployment in March 2026. Full record A technical webinar of June 2025 described the biometric identity card's architecture, including a QR-encoded verifiable credential and an identity-verification authentication and know-your-customer module (webinar). Ceremonial enrolment for citizens aged 18 and over opened in January 2026 with a district pilot (launch). A steering committee validated the pilot results in March 2026 and authorised nationwide deployment of 2,500 enrolment kits (committee). No relying party, authentication volume or service using the module in production is named.	Advanced
Malawi	A mobile identity wallet was announced for September 2026 and a separate blockchain identity wallet is in pilot, and the base cannot establish whether they are the same product. Full record The mobile wallet was named and announced for a September 2026 launch, complementing rather than replacing the plastic card, requiring prior registration and needing no periodic renewal; it was not live in August 2026, and rights advocates have flagged equal-access, rural-exclusion, cybersecurity and literacy caveats (wallet, launch, target). A blockchain-enabled wallet built by a development agency with an international computing centre is in pilot before nationwide rollout, with credentials to extend to birth certificates, driving licences and marriage certificates; no pilot scale, rollout date or cost is stated, and nothing is stated on how the arrangement sits under the data protection statute (blockchain, plan). Neither announcement names the other.	Advanced
Mauritania	A national public key infrastructure and certificate management system went to tender in two lots under donor credit and was twice extended, with no award held. Full record The tender was extended to a bid deadline of 21 July 2026 by a second addendum, with evaluation reweighted to 40 per cent technical and 60 per cent cost (tender). The notice title promises a national digital identity system but the operative text describes only electronic certification integrating with the existing register, so what is being procured is narrower than what it is called. No award is held.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mauritius	The Mobile ID wallet has been in service since September 2024 and is hosted on the sovereign facility, with no user or issuance figure published. Full record The wallet launched in September 2024 with a foreign vendor under the 2024 national identity card regulations (launch, regulations). It is now hosted on the Rose-Belle facility and still carries no published user or issuance figure. A domestic analysis welcomed its convenience and pressed for privacy and surveillance safeguards around the enabling regulations (analysis).	No change
Morocco	Facial recognition is permitted case by case for remote bank account opening and benefit proof of life, both on prior authorisation since 2020. Full record Remote account opening was permitted by a deliberation of April 2020, conditional on a prior undertaking to migrate authentication to a future national trusted-third-party system that is not established as built (banking). Proof of life for benefit recipients was permitted by a deliberation of July 2020 on the same migration condition, agreed with the insurance and social-security supervisor (benefits). No authorisation count, revocation record or migration record is held for either.	No change
Mozambique	A national mobile digital identity and electronic signature infrastructure went to tender in May 2026, with partner discussions opened in August. Full record The digital transformation agency floated a tender in May 2026 for a national mobile digital identity and electronic signature infrastructure (tender, partner search). The ICT institute opened discussions with a local partner in August 2026 on a platform extending digital identity, advanced digital signatures and public key infrastructure into a national digital trust layer; it follows a February 2026 memorandum with a foreign institute covering credentialing, auditing, training and technical assistance for operating a root certification authority (discussions).	Advanced
Namibia	A biometric fingerprint system underpins identity checks, and a chipped electronic identity card with remote authentication launches in September 2026. Full record The home affairs ministry's own annual report describes the operational biometric fingerprint system and the electronic birth management system connectivity that underpin identity verification (report). The minister confirmed in Parliament a September 2026 rollout of electronic identity cards, following delays to finalise legislation on data protection and identity management (confirmation). A pilot ran at Otjimbingwe from September 2025 and a public awareness campaign explaining the consent-based authentication model opened in Omaheke in August 2026 (campaign). The card is free at the point of issue for first-time applicants and carries a digital identity component for remote authentication. The legislation the launch waited on is still not enacted.	Advanced
Niger	A national public key infrastructure was enumerated as planned in July 2025 and nothing on record has been built. Full record It was listed by the critical-infrastructure committee alongside the cybersecurity centre and the forensics laboratory (infrastructure). No trust anchor, certification authority or electronic-signature capability exists for the country on this record, which is the layer the biometric card would need to authenticate against anything other than itself.	No change

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Nigeria	Consent-based verification went live in May 2025, the identity commission holds the national root certification authority, and airport identity verification runs on number and face. Full record Consent-based verification launched in May 2025 (verification). The root certification authority role was handed over from the technology agency, with the wider partnership formalised in July 2026 covering the key-infrastructure transfer and harmonised digital-trust standards; it creates an overlap with the electronic-signature provisions of the still-pending economy bill, and which instrument governs digital signatures is unresolved (overlap, duties, certification). Travellers enrol identity number and face biometrics for digital security checks and boarding (airport).	Advanced
South Africa	The online verification service is running with its fee under review litigation, and no accuracy, volume or uptime measure for it is held. Full record The standing position is an online identity verification service in operation, with its fee the subject of a review application. Nothing in the twelve months to 2026-08-26 resolves that litigation or changes the service. What the base does not hold is any measure of it: no query volume, no match accuracy, no uptime and no list of which institutions consume it. The one adjacent movement is in the draft identification regulations, which would grant accredited trusted entities interface access to the population register under data-sharing agreements — a second authentication route, not yet made, and reported under the legislation indicator rather than here.	No change
Tunisia	The mobile identity credential became compulsory for investment declarations and business registration from 1 July 2026 — two public-service rails switching on the same date. Full record It was made compulsory for investment declarations and for business registration from 1 July 2026 (mandate, register, milestone). Two independent public-service rails switched to compulsory digital identity on the same date, which is a coordination decision rather than two coincidences. No enrolment count, coverage figure or fallback for a user without the credential is published, and the mobile application announced for government services depends on this same identity layer.	Advanced
Zambia	A national authentication service runs single sign-on, OpenID Connect, multi-factor and passwordless credentials for e-government. Full record The state technology institute publishes the service description of the national authentication and access-control service: single sign-on, OpenID Connect, multi-factor authentication and passwordless credentials for electronic government services. An operating authentication service with named protocols is the strongest identity artefact on this ledger, and it is what makes the downstream uses recorded elsewhere possible. The page is undated, so the position is dated to retrieval, and no user count, uptime figure or list of relying services is published — so the base can describe the service and not its reach.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Zimbabwe	Identity rests on the National Registration Act; a nationwide handover in August 2026 puts voter registration under the same authority and sub-offices are being computerised. Full record The National Registration Act, consolidated to 31 December 2016, is the statute under which the register of residents and the issue of identity documents sit (Act). The civil registry department and the electoral commission began a nationwide joint transfer of voter registration and voters' roll management to the registrar-general on 18 August 2026, provincial and district officers of both bodies meeting in Harare to operationalise it (handover). The home affairs ministry announced in October 2025 that civil registry sub-offices would be computerised countrywide to safeguard citizens' records; ten sub-offices across eight districts are now being computerised, digitalised and solar-powered under a China-funded, UNICEF-managed project (announcement, project). No authentication service, credential or transaction count is published, and the national digital identity itself remains announced and unlaunched.	Advanced

Digital id from birth

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Angola	Registry posts opened in maternity wards in one province so newborns leave registered and issued a first identity card, with no national rollout published. Full record 2026-03-04 — registry posts in maternity wards were launched in one province, running there since October 2025, so that newborns leave registered and issued a first identity card, foreign-funded with United Nations support, following the start of card issuance to newborns in November 2025. No national rollout map, no registration count and no target is published, so what the base holds is one province and a stated model. The universalisation programme reported under registration names cards at birth as one of its three phases, which is the nearest thing to a plan on file. The measure that would test it runs the other way: birth registration among children aged nought to four is the weakest cohort in the census, reported under the civil register.	Advanced
Botswana	A unique number is issued at birth registration and becomes the Omang number at sixteen; no digital credential sits behind it. Full record 2026-08-01 — the statistics office describes the birth and death registration system as partially automated and decentralised, integrated with the identification system, with the identifier issued at birth carrying through to the identity card at sixteen. 2025-11-25 — an electronic identity card was piloted and a feasibility study commissioned. No digital credential is issued at birth, and the base holds no birth-registration completeness figure.	No change, a number from birth on paper rails
Burundi	The civil registry's link to health facilities now runs in 123 facilities and has recorded more than 52,000 births, on the interior ministry's own count. Full record 2026-08-11 — the civil-registry to health-facility link for birth registration, piloted since 2023 and institutionalised in 2024, is stated to run in 123 health facilities and to have recorded more than 52,000 births. The figures are the ministry's own and no coverage denominator is given, so the share of births captured is not knowable from the record. A national unique identifier is planned with fingerprint and facial biometrics, which would be the link from registration at birth to a credential. Nothing states when, or how a child registered through a health facility today obtains one.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cameroon	Digital birth certificates entered routine issuance across ten municipalities in three regions from January 2026. A drive to reach one million primary-school pupils holding no certificate was found far from its target and restarts in September 2026. Full record The certificates were provided for in the 2024 civil-registration law with none issued at the window's opening. The first was issued at a Limbe council in January 2026, and issuance is now routine across ten municipalities in three regions, with the same legal worth as physical certificates. 2026-08-07 - equipment for three pilot centres digitising civil-status registration went out to tender by the United Nations development programme, the centres, their locations, the value and the timetable not named. Three pilot centres is the whole of that scope, against a register the base elsewhere records being used to draw fraudulent payroll claims. 2026-08-26 — a drive launched in 2024 to reach one million pupils holding no birth certificate was found far from its target, and the Basic Education minister ordered pupils' files submitted to the courts before 15 September, restarting mobile court hearings from September. No count of certificates issued under the 2024 drive is published, so the shortfall is stated and not measured. The court route is not discretionary: the law requires a declaratory judgment wherever the 90-day deadline was missed.	Mixed, routine issuance began in ten municipalities while a one-million-pupil registration drive missed its target and restarts
Cape Verde	Birth registration reached 99%, with a unique identification number issued to every child at birth, from about 91% before the linkage reforms. Full record Coverage stood at about 91% before the linkage reforms, with fragmented systems and weak institutional coordination. 2026-05 - the justice-modernisation institute reported 99% birth registration and 100% registration of deaths occurring in health facilities, reached within five years, with a unique identification number issued to every child at birth. The figures are the institute's own and are registration coverage, not identity-card coverage. It is the strongest measured position on this ledger, and the only one on it where a stated outcome rather than an instrument has moved.	Advanced
Chad	A child birth-registration campaign opened a six-month first phase, backed by a moratorium on court fees for supplementary birth judgments until 2030. Full record The campaign runs a first phase of six months to December 2026; one account puts its household component in twelve provinces and another says every province (campaign, registration, identity). The fee moratorium was signed in February 2026, suspending court fees for children aged four months to seventeen years until 2030; the instrument's own text is not held and its terms are known only from launch statements (moratorium). Health-facility-integrated registration is reported by a practitioner, with stated plans to raise digitised hospital points from ninety-seven to six hundred and reach zero unregistered births by 2030 (facilities), and a francophone civil-registration project has a second phase in preparation on the organisation's own claim (project).	Advanced
Comoros	A birth-registration campaign was launched in September 2025 above a 2023 law providing for computerised civil status. Full record The legal basis is in place and the system is not. The law promulgated on 25 September 2023 amends the 1984 civil-status law to provide for computerised processing of civil-status data, a national civil-status and population register and a civil-status agency; the agency is still a draft decree in island consultation. 2025-09 - a campaign was launched in Moroni to raise birth-registration rates, particularly in remote areas, run with the national human rights commission. 2026-08 - at the African civil registration day the interior minister and the modernisation project's coordinator tied digitised registration of newborns in rural communities to legal identity. No registration rate is on file at either end.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cote d'Ivoire	283 digital birth-registration terminals were handed to Tonkpi health workers to link maternities to civil-registry offices. Full record 2026-08-11 - the identification office handed 283 digital birth-registration terminals to health workers in the Tonkpi region to link maternities directly to civil-registry offices under a zero-invisible-child programme, part of a digitisation the office also reported in the Goh region. 2026-06-09 - national-language announcers were trained as community relays on civil registration and the identification number, with community collection points to follow; no number of speakers trained, budget or coverage is stated. No registration outcome is attached to either: the terminal count and the training are inputs, and the on-time registration rate they exist to move has not been republished.	Advanced
Djibouti	The identification number is assigned from birth by law; civil registration that would trigger it stays largely paper-based. Full record The rule has stood since before the period: the founding law assigns the national identification number from birth, and its implementing decree defines it as a digital instrument combining civil-status and personal data and requires it on property, hospital, school, university, utility and commercial records. What the base does not hold is the mechanism. A comparative regional report finds no electronic records in local civil-registration offices for births or deaths, no central national civil-registration database, and paper-based transmission between registration levels and institutions. No birth-registration rate, and no count of numbers assigned at birth, is published.	No change
DR Congo	A rural eastern sector has had no birth registers for several months and newborn registration has stopped outright. Full record 2026-07-25 - a sector chief told the provincial interior division that his civil-status office has had no birth registers for several months, that newborn registration has stopped outright, and that the province promised resupply with no date. The stated consequences are exclusion from school enrolment and from proof of nationality. It is the concrete measure of how far civil-registry modernisation reaches into rural territories, and it runs in the same year a national digital identity platform launched in Kinshasa. No registration rate, register-stock figure or resupply programme appears anywhere on this ledger.	Regressed
Eswatini	The Closing of the Tap initiative registers newborns inside health facilities under the Civil Registration Act of 2023, with offices in seven towns. Full record The ministry's own retrospective describes the Civil Registration Act of 2023 and an initiative registering newborns directly within health facilities, with registration offices now open in seven towns (ministry). A unique identification number is issued at birth and appears on both the birth-registration record and the birth certificate (scoping study). Registration completeness stands at 61 per cent of births in 2025 (commemoration), so the pathway exists for rather more than half of newborns. What is issued at birth is a number and a certificate, not a credential: the identity document itself comes at 16 under the 1998 Order, and no count of births registered through the health-facility route is held.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Ethiopia	Birth registration is being extended operationally, including backlog clearance for refugee children in Afar (mission). Full record A joint field mission by the refugee service with UNICEF, UNHCR and the Immigration and Citizenship Service cleared birth-registration backlogs and assessed service delivery for refugee children in Semera and Asayita refugee camp in April 2026 (mission). The government's own account of civil registration digitalisation describes family and vital-event registration running digitally from the central level down to woreda level (statement). The base holds no birth-registration rate, and nothing states whether a registered birth produces a national identity number, so the link this indicator asks about is not evidenced either way.	No change, a first statement of the position with nothing measuring registration at birth
Guinea	Birth registration was put at 72 per cent for 2025 from 54 per cent in 2022, on a base where communes ran out of secured paper. Full record The figures are the territorial administration minister's own, given in a ceremonial statement with no statistical source named (minister's figures). A civil-registration officer said on 7 August 2026 that the secured paper the digital birth certificate is printed on had run out, leaving communes across the capital and beyond unable to issue extracts for about a month; his own commune processes all applicants regardless of home commune and holds reserve stock for urgent cases (stockout). No ministry statement, restocking date or national count of affected communes is held.	Mixed, the registration rate rose while the paper the certificate is printed on ran out
Kenya	A statute mandates a civil-registration office in each of 290 sub-counties, with the identifier issued at birth feeding automatic identity at 18. Full record The amendment Act was assented in February 2026, shifting vetting to birth registration (statute, reform direction). A digital birth-notification system links hospitals to the registry against the national identifier, live in one county and one hospital, with no national rollout date or facility count on file (notification).	Advanced
Lesotho	A unique personal identification number is issued on birth registration, with a scale-up roadmap to 2030. Full record 2011-03-21 – the founding Act provides for a unique identity number at registration, including for children entered through a parent or guardian. 2026-07-18 – the registry's own presentation states a unique personal identification number is issued on birth registration, with a nationwide scale-up roadmap running to 2030. 2026-04-01 – a proposal was put to use maternal health records to trigger earlier birth registration. No birth-registration completeness figure is published, so how many children the number actually reaches cannot be stated.	Advanced
Madagascar	A unique identification number at birth has been mandated in law since 2018, with assignment mechanisms only now in place. Full record Article 38 of the civil status law of November 2018 mandates a state-issued unique identification number assigned to every person at birth, applicable nationwide (law). The base holds no figure for how many newborns have been assigned one, no registration completeness rate, and no account of the mechanism by which a birth declaration generates the number. The capture stops at article 111 of 152, so the law's later provisions on the registers and their maintenance are not in the base.	No change

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Malawi	58 health facilities issued point-of-care digital birth certificates in 2025, with registration assigning a lifelong identity number. Full record The bureau's plan treats birth-to-identity linkage as a 2025-2030 objective, with birth registration being integrated to assign a national identity number at birth. 2026-02 - 58 health facilities issued point-of-care digital birth certificates during 2025, 104,177 births registered and 56,268 certificates issued, with registration now assigning a lifelong identity number. Certificates run at just over half of registrations and nothing on file explains the gap. 2026-07 - the third phase of the national campaign was under way with cumulative registration past 3.5 million children of an estimated 7.5 million eligible. Under half the children in the country have been reached.	Advanced
Mozambique	A mass campaign launched in March 2026 targets up to 7 million citizens by December through 500 mobile brigades issuing a birth certificate and, first time round, the identity card on the spot, free of charge. Full record 2026-03-20 — the justice ministry launched a mass civil-registration campaign of about US\$9m targeting up to 7 million citizens by December 2026, through up to 500 mobile brigades that jointly issue a birth certificate and, for first-time applicants, the national identity card on the spot and free of charge. Issuing both in one encounter is what makes this an identity-from-birth movement rather than a registration drive. The system behind it registers births and deaths by USSD, SMS and web, coordinated across justice, health, interior and the statistics institute, with the stated objective of a single lifecycle citizen identification number linking civil registration to civil identification. 2026-04-27 — a package of memoranda with Ethiopia covered digital transformation with a stated emphasis on digital identity and public infrastructure, bringing another country's identity-system experience into the build. No registration figure against the 7 million target is yet published.	Advanced
Namibia	A unique identity number is created for every child notified at birth, and electronic notification now runs across 153 facilities. Full record The population registration system creates a unique identity number for every child notified at birth, from the electronic birth-notification rollout of 2016 to 2018 onward (case study). Electronic birth and death notification operate across 153 facilities on the home affairs minister's account, with birth-registration coverage put near 99 per cent (coverage). Staff were deployed to 24 state hospitals in December 2025 to issue certificates immediately after delivery (hospitals). A mobile identity prototype was tested so a remote mother could register a newborn by phone with a digital signature (prototype). 126,737 birth certificates were issued in calendar 2025 (documents). What is issued at birth is a number and a certificate; the credential comes later, and from September 2026.	Advanced
Nigeria	A new identity commission Act was assented in June 2026, and the population commission states under-fives receive an identity number at birth registration. Full record The Act replaced the 2007 statute as the legal foundation of the national identity system and makes the national identification number the foundational credential. The population commission states that under-five children are to receive a national identification number at the point of birth registration and that its electronic civil registration system is interoperable with the identity commission; no figure for numbers issued at birth is published.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Senegal	The externally funded civil-registration modernisation programme closed at a final steering committee in June 2026 — a programme closure rather than a capability closure. Full record The final steering committee was held on 29 June 2026, closing the programme (closure, programme). It is the only European governance instrument on file for the country. The capability it built continues — software is deployed across most centres and millions of records are loaded — but the financing that built it has ended, and the agency running it says its own 2026 budget has not been notified.	Stalled
South Africa	680,555 babies were registered within 30 days of birth in 2025/26 against a 677,000 target, with automation in health facilities still planned. Full record 2026-05-15 — 680,555 babies were registered within 30 days of birth in 2025/26 against a target of 677,000, with automation of the birth process in health facilities still planned for 2026/27. It is the department's own figure and no total-births denominator is given, so the share registered in time is not derivable. The statutory basis is old and unchanged: the Births and Deaths Registration Act has been in force since 1992, held as an excerpt. The link to a credential is what the white paper reported under interoperability proposes to build; today the registration is timely and the identity that follows from it is a separate transaction.	Advanced
Tanzania	Registration from birth is in pilot with under-fives linked to the mother's identity because no biometric solution works for them, and the pilot ran about six months ahead of its enabling bill. Full record The registration agency and identity authority are linking to issue the identifier from birth; under-fives are linked to the mother's identity, and as at August 2026 the minister reports over 22 million people holding a national identification number as of April 2026 and describes the two agencies' integration as the route by which the identifier is issued from birth, with no integration milestone, date or technical description accompanying it (pilot, children, rollout). The enabling bill was set for a session opening in January 2026 and was not tabled; one source's headline says the scheme rolls out where its body says only that government is preparing to table, and the body governs (bill, registration). The identifier as a distinct issued credential was named a 2026/27 budget priority, having been declared design-complete in March 2024 with an end-2025 conclusion target (identifier, design).	Mixed, a from-birth registration pilot running about six months ahead of the bill that would enable it
Zambia	Civil registration funding was raised 67 per cent after advocacy, against only 22 per cent of under-fives with registered births. Full record The Births and Deaths Registration Act of 1973 requires uniform registration of every birth and death, the statutory root from which a birth-time identity number would derive. 2026-05 — advocacy reversed a proposed cut and secured a 67 per cent funding increase for civil registration in the 2026 budget, and helped establish a 26-member parliamentary caucus in October 2025, explicitly framed as the foundation the digital identity reform needs, since only 22 per cent of under-fives have registered births and 15 per cent in rural areas. Those two percentages are the finding. An identity number issued at birth reaches roughly a fifth of children, and a budget increase is the first movement toward changing that.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Zimbabwe	Birth registration stands at 57 per cent, and ten rural sub-offices are being computerised to widen access to registration at the point of birth. Full record The Births and Deaths Registration Act, in force as amended to 6 March 2020, requires registration of births, still-births and deaths (Act). Birth registration coverage stands at 57 per cent, with no later national figure held (coverage). Ten decentralised civil registry sub-offices across eight districts are being computerised, digitalised and solar-powered under a China-funded, UNICEF-managed project, aimed at children and families in remote communities who need legal identity documents to reach health, education and social protection (project). A provincial registry office commissioned in Mutare in September 2025 for biometric passport and identity services was described by the registrar-general as foundational to a digital identity system (registry office). There is no identity credential issued at birth: registration produces a paper certificate, and the identity document comes later.	Advanced

Interoperability of birth registration and digital id

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Angola	The identity card is generated from the birth record by system interoperability, a link standing since 2017 and unmeasured since. Full record The link exists and is old. The card is generated from the birth record by system interoperability, on a platform installed with foreign assistance in 2017 that tied card issuance to birth registration from the start. Nothing in the twelve months to 2026-08-26 states how well it works. No figure exists for how many registrations produce a card, how long the step takes, or what happens to the 39.2% of children aged nought to four registered at the 2024 census — the population the link is supposed to serve. The maternity-ward posts reported above are the operational answer being built, and they are in one province.	No change
Botswana	Online registration of births, deaths and marriages is complete and waiting on the government platform to go live. Full record 2015-09 — a country report set out the identity lifecycle from birth registration through to the identity card at sixteen, the base's fullest technical account of the link. 2026-02-24 — the ministry reported digitisation of online birth, death and marriage registration complete, awaiting the government platform's go-live. The marriage register is still manual, and no go-live date is held.	Advanced
Burundi	The country's own account states civil registration is not yet interoperable with the future digital identity; interoperability with health facilities is planned. Full record 2026-07 — Burundi's country presentation to the African registrars general meeting states the position plainly: paper-based and manual elements persist, there is no single national civil-status database, and civil registration is not yet fully interoperable with the future national digital identification system. 2026-08-10 — the territorial administration directorate set out planned interoperability with health facilities for births and deaths, with notification through hill chiefs, alongside a national digital identity carrying a unique identifier and biometrics. The two accounts a month apart give the shape of it: the link is designed and not built, and the register it would connect to does not yet exist as a single database.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cameroon	An implementation partner was engaged for civil-registration digitisation with a 2029 target, to integrate with the biometric card and the voter kits. Full record No implementation partner was named at the window's opening. In October 2025 one was engaged, with a fully digital target for 2029 and a stated intention to integrate with the biometric identity card and the voter enrolment kits. That is the only stated link between civil registration and the identity credential anywhere on this ledger, and it is an intention with a four-year horizon rather than a built interface. No design, standard, milestone or interim deliverable has been published, and the event date is month-precision only.	Advanced
Comoros	The 2023 law provides for a national civil-status and population register; the identifier meant to join it to identity is unissued. Full record The law provides for computerised civil-status data and a national civil-status and population register, and the personal identification number provided for by the same law was designated the cornerstone of citizen identity, with interoperability to other state systems specified, at a validation workshop in March 2026. No issuance date, coverage target or numbering scheme has been published since. 2026-08 - the civil registration day ceremony tied digitised birth registration for rural newborns to legal identity, which is a statement of intent rather than a link built. A register that exists in law and an identifier that exists in a validated framework do not yet meet.	No change, the number designed to link them is still at framework validation
Cote d'Ivoire	At the new terminals a parent's national identity card populates the child's identity data directly - the only stated link between the two registers. Full record 2026-08-11 - the civil-registry office presented terminals for systematic birth registration on which a parent's national identity card populates the child's identity data directly, at the ninth African civil registration day. The claim to be the first in West Africa to use the technology for systematic birth registration is the office's own, and no deployment count or registration figure is published for the mechanism. It is the only stated link between birth registration and the identity register anywhere on this ledger; nothing states whether the child receives an identification number at that point or later.	Advanced
Djibouti	Civil-registry archive digitisation is under way with no completion date; the link to the identity register is not evidenced. Full record The law provides the link in principle - the register of natural persons is the source for every secure document and the land register may cross-check identity documents against the national population database. In practice a regional survey finds no central civil-registration database and fully paper-based exchange between registration levels and institutions. The one movement is preparatory: archive digitisation at the population directorate is under way, with no completion date published. No interface between civil registration and the identity register appears in the record.	No change

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Eritrea	Birth registration feeds the regional population registers, and a national identity card is required before a passport is issued (guidance). Full record Operational country guidance published in March 2026 states that Eritrea issues national identity cards and that a national identity document is required before an Eritrean passport can be issued (guidance). Birth registration feeds the zoba population registers through the local family register and transfer documents, and the identity and residence cards are printed extracts of those registers (technical description). The chain therefore exists but is regional rather than national, and the base holds no birth-registration coverage rate, so how many children enter it is not known.	No change
Eswatini	A unique identification number issued at birth appears on both the registration record and the certificate, linking civil registration to the population register. Full record A seven-country regional scoping study confirms that a unique identification number is issued at birth and carried on both the birth-registration record and the birth certificate (study). The annual vital statistics report is the base's clearest primary description of how that number assignment links registration to the national population register (report). The draft data governance policy names birth-certificate services among the intended uses of the proposed national exchange platform (proposal). The same study finds registrars in some of the seven countries making a citizenship determination at the point of birth registration, which is a linkage that decides status rather than merely records it.	Advanced
Kenya	Civil registration and the identity system were presented as integrated at a regional registrars-general meeting in July 2026. Full record Amendment rules under the Births and Deaths Registration Act were made in October 2024 (rules). Kenya presented its civil registration and national identity integration to the annual regional expert group meeting for registrars-general in July 2026, under a session on interoperability (presentation). Administration officers were trained on the revised registration system in June 2026 (training). The presentation is the only account of the integration held, and it states no volume, coverage rate or date from which the link has operated.	Advanced
Lesotho	The registry runs an integrated civil registration and identity architecture, now under a modernisation framework. Full record 2022-05 — an assessment documents the integrated civil registration and national identity architecture and the interoperability gaps left in it. 2026-02-26 — the 2026 work plan frames civil registration and digital identity development together. 2026-06-29 — a stakeholder consultation opened on a systems architecture and modernisation framework covering both. The architecture is integrated on paper and the gaps named in 2022 have not been reported closed.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Madagascar	A law of 28 May 2026 lets births be registered en masse inside the biometric enrolment operation, against a de-duplicated database. Full record Late birth registration had been available only through a costly judicial process; the new law permits mass registration within enrolment, with over 2,000 teams and more than 19,000 local chiefs confirming identities against a de-duplicated database (law). About six million adults, roughly 40 per cent, lacked a birth certificate (identity), so the interoperability here is not a technical link between two working registers but the use of one operation to populate both at once.	Advanced
Malawi	970,400 birth records were synchronised into the central register and one app now covers four vital events. Full record The design is stated in the bureau's own plan: civil registration kits synchronising with the central register, and an integration layer exchanging data between the civil registration and identity management subsystems. 2026-01 - the integrated registration application was fully tested for national identity, birth, death and marriage registration with online and offline biometric verification, and moved toward phased deployment. 2026-02 - the first phase of the birth registration campaign synchronised 970,400 of 1.1 million targeted child records into the central register, which is the exchange working on nearly a million records rather than in specification.	Advanced
Mozambique	Hospital births notify the civil register electronically in nineteen facilities of one province, against a civil registration system the Code integrates with the identity system. Full record Real-time digital birth registration launched on 22 July 2024, connecting the hospital birth module to the electronic civil registration system; the pilot expanded from five to nineteen health facilities in Inhambane province and registered over 11,589 newborns, with health workers entering birth data directly and receiving instant confirmation (integration). The civil registration system is itself established by the revised Civil Registration Code as integrated with the national identity and health systems (code). Coverage is one province of eleven, nationwide expansion carries no date, and no figure later than 2024 is held.	Advanced
Namibia	Birth, identity, marriage and death modules were staged into one person profile against the unique identity number between 2012 and 2014. Full record The case study traces the staged integration of the birth, identity, marriage and death modules into a single person profile in the population registration system, keyed to the unique identity number assigned at birth notification (case study). Electronic notification reached 126 facilities by December 2025 and 153 by March 2026, which is the pipe that carries a birth into that profile (facilities). The electronic identity card launching in September 2026 is the credential that would sit on top of it (launch). Namibia's birth-to-identity chain is the most complete on this base among its neighbours, and the thing it has never had is a data protection statute governing what flows along it.	Advanced
Nigeria	The population commission states its civil registration system is interoperable with the identity commission, and a new identity Act strengthened the legal basis for that exchange. Full record The commission's own dated statement puts the electronic civil registration system as interoperable with the identity commission and other identity agencies, with access to immunisation and social-welfare records. The identity commission Act 2026 replaced the 2007 statute and made the national identification number the foundational credential, strengthening the legal basis for registry-to-identity data exchange. No volume of records exchanged is published.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Senegal	Birth registration coverage rests on two instruments on different bases, and an audit of civil registration in 74 communes covering 2018 to 2025 was launched in July 2026. Full record The coverage figures come from two instruments on different bases — a census stock figure and a survey coverage rate — which is why they cannot be read as one series (coverage). The audit mission was launched at Rufisque on 28 July 2026 covering 2018 to 2025. It tests the reliability of the paper base the digital register is built on, and no findings or reporting date are stated (audit). An audit of that scope, opened while the register is being loaded, is the right sequence and the one the record most often shows reversed elsewhere in this unit.	Mixed, birth registration coverage advancing while an audit tests the reliability of the paper base the digital register is built on
South Africa	Cabinet approved a white paper anchoring digital identity in an intelligent population register with real-time integration and digitally enabled mandatory birth and death registration. Full record 2026-04-08 — Cabinet approved the Revised White Paper on Citizenship, Immigration and Refugee Protection, anchoring civil-registration reform in turning the National Population Register into an Intelligent Population Register through biometrics, interoperability and real-time integration as the foundation for digital identity, alongside digitally enabled mandatory birth and death registration. It is a white paper rather than a bill, and the identification statute it anticipates is carried separately on this ledger. What it states plainly is the design: registration at birth and the digital credential are to be one system rather than two, which is the position this indicator asks about and which no instrument has yet delivered. No timetable, cost or architecture is published with it.	Advanced
Zambia	A system integrator was invited to deploy and integrate foundational identity and civil registration modules, over a regulation deriving the card number from the birth record. Full record Regulation 6(2)(a) of the National Registration Regulations, 2019 is the clearest legal linkage: for a person born in Zambia the national registration card number is derived from that person's birth-registration record. The link exists in law. 2025-09 — the acceleration project invited vendors for a system integrator to deploy, customise and integrate foundational digital identity and civil registration core modules, including data migration and enrolment kits — the procurement that would make the legal link technical. 2026-04 — the country's civil registration experience informed validation of a continental interoperability framework's non-functional requirements; it is not among the six pilot countries.	Advanced
Zimbabwe	A secure exchange platform for birth and death notifications is in build, with automated validation against the national population register and a pilot set for 2027. Full record The registrar-general's ICT deputy told the regional registrars' meeting on 18 July 2026 that Zimbabwe is still in the implementation phase, with a secure interoperability platform being built to exchange birth and death notifications between health facilities and the civil registry (presentation). The same account names automated validation and synchronisation against the national population register as the mechanism for minimising duplicate records, and sets a roadmap of a business intelligence module in the third quarter of 2026, middleware design in the fourth, training through 2026 and 2027, and a three-province pilot in the first half of 2027 (roadmap). Registry modernisation itself remains under way with no completion date and no coverage figure. Nothing interoperable is yet in service: what the base holds is a design, a roadmap and an acknowledged gap.	Advanced

Use by other systems

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	Remote biometric passport renewal opened to the diaspora on 24 June 2026. Full record The service did not exist at the window's opening. 2026-06-24 - remote renewal opened to consular applicants. No application count, processing time or issuance figure has been published since. It is the clearest use of the identity layer by a service that is not itself an identity service, and it reaches a population outside the country - which makes the absence of any stated data-transfer basis, in a state with mandatory in-country localisation, the open question the record does not address.	Advanced
Angola	A bill would make the identity card the only valid document for banking, telecoms, school enrolment and contracts, and a law makes it the sole electoral credential from 2027. Full record 2026-04-29 — the Council of Ministers approved a bill making the identity card the only valid document for banking, telecommunications, school enrolment, property registration and contracts, replacing an arrangement in which voter cards, driving licences and passports are accepted substitutes. No parliamentary stage has followed. Separately, an official electoral registration law replaces in-person enrolment with automatic enrolment drawn from the civil identity database, with the voter card used for the last time in 2027 and the identity card becoming the sole registration credential thereafter. No gazette reference is on file and the law reaches the base through a secondary account. Both make the card load-bearing for services it does not yet reach: 52.4% of the population aged five and over holds one. Nothing on the ledger records an authentication service, an interface or a verification volume behind either instrument.	Advanced
Benin	Identity is required for SIM registration and now carries diaspora passport renewal in more than 80 countries. Full record 2025-04-30 — unregistered SIM cards were deactivated under a regulator order, an anti-fraud measure that reporting itself noted demands a strong data-protection frame. The position is unchanged since. 2025-10-24 — a diaspora biometric passport renewal platform went live, available in more than 80 countries with renewals reported at about 15 minutes, built by an external vendor on the national exchange and tied to national identity and immigration systems. The register's reach is the country's distinguishing feature and is measured under the population register below. What is missing across both cases is any published rule on which body may query identity for what purpose: the access conventions reported under data exchange are the nearest thing, and they govern connection rather than use.	Advanced
Botswana	Identity-linked SIM registration has been mandatory for all users since March 2024, with no later regulator statement or registration rate held. Full record Registration has been mandatory for all users since a public notice of March 2024. Nothing has moved it: no later regulator statement, registration rate or de-registration figure is held. It is the only case on this ledger of the national identity being required by another system, and it is the oldest instrument in this section. Nothing states what identity document satisfies it, which matters against the card replacement failures reported above, or how it is verified without the certificate layer the country does not have.	No change

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Burundi	There is no central national identity database able to support digital know-your-customer; identity is consumed as a document, not as a query. Full record A payment-infrastructure assessment records that the national identity system is non-biometric and that there is no central national identity database able to support digital know-your-customer, national identity cards being presented as documentary evidence at account opening rather than authenticated against a register. It distinguishes identity interoperability from the payment switch, which does exist. That is the position the whole of this chapter rests on. Every system that requires identity in the window — the financial sector's customer identification rules, compulsory SIM registration, social protection enrolment — verifies a piece of paper, because there is nothing to ask.	No change
Cameroon	Compulsory taxi and driver registration opened at Yaounde with a QR code per driver, and a student digital identity was provided for. Full record 2026-07-03 to 2026-10-05 - compulsory registration on a city platform opened, with a QR code and a unique door number per driver, unregistered taxis barred after the deadline. It is a city council order with development-agency support. 2026-06 - a memorandum addendum provided for a secondary-school student digital identity card linked to academic, financial and disciplinary records and to school-fee payment, replacing a unique student identification number assigned through a ministry portal since 2024; no issuance is reported and no signature date is published. Neither is stated to draw on the national register, so both are sectoral credentials rather than uses of the foundational identity.	Advanced
Chad	A mass enrolment and subscriber-data partnership was signed with a mobile operator, wiring subscriber data into the identity register. Full record The partnership was signed in May 2026 (partnership). It wires subscriber data into the identity register with no data-protection authority on file overseeing it. No enrolment target, retention rule, consent mechanism or regulator role is stated. Together with the finance ministry's real-time feed, that gives the register two live interconnections and no supervision.	Advanced
Comoros	A digital identity layer is asserted as a workload of the public-administration data centre, with no architecture or timetable. Full record The layer is asserted by the agency that would run it, the data centre stated to support the national domain name system, digital identity and service portals, with no architecture, standard, supplier, timetable or coverage target, and no counterpart line at any grain in the 2025 or 2026 vote. It reaches the base through a rolling agency page dated by proxy. A biometric driving-licence programme, named in the 2025 budget bill, is still named in no finance law at any grain, with no instrument, tender, supplier or issuance date on record, and the 2026 classification carries no line for it, nor for a national identity card, biometric enrolment, passport system or voter register.	No change
Congo	The unique identification number is now the authentication key for the public-revenue platform and mandatory for thirteen formalities. Full record The number is now the authentication key for the public-revenue platform and for real-time invoice validation, and mandatory for eight economic and five administrative or social formalities. That is a substantial dependency built on a credential whose coverage is unpublished: no national issuance figure exists, and the base records cards going uncollected in the thousands in a single city. Nothing states what a person without the number does when a formality requires it, or whether any alternative route remains open.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cote d'Ivoire	A postal application carrying identity-card, birth-certificate and criminal-record applications was launched in January 2026. Full record 2026-01 - a register-backed application for mail and parcel management, identity-card, birth-certificate and criminal-record applications was launched, with card delivery through more than 200 post offices. No download, registration or transaction figure has been published since launch, so what the route carries is unknown. The postal operator is the second commercial-scale consumer of the register in the window, after the bank authentication service, and neither has a published legal basis for the query.	Advanced
Djibouti	The mobile identity system authenticates for partner administrations server-to-server, without exposing the biometric database. Full record Nothing of the kind existed when the period opened. 2026-02-10 - the mobile identity system was launched with biometric authentication, partner administrations querying the authentication service server-to-server rather than reaching the biometric databases directly, positioned as complementary to the identification number and civil-registry modernisation. Closing the forum that launched it, the President set out identity theft, cloning, hacking, espionage and over-centralisation as the risks alongside the benefits. No relying party is named, no service is on record as connected, and no authentication volume is published - the architecture is stated by its owner and not evidenced in use.	Advanced
DR Congo	The biometric passport stands at US\$75, 2,400 a day across 100 stations, with no later figure held. Full record The passport price was cut to US\$75 with a new supplier and online enrolment, on 50 fixed and mobile stations plus 50 at missions and a stated 2,400 a day, against prior prices of US\$185 then US\$99, under a 2022 contract worth US\$48m. No later price, volume or station figure is held, so the position is unchanged through the window. Nothing states whether the passport draws on, or will draw on, the identity platform launched in June 2026, which is the question the indicator asks and which no held source addresses.	No change
Egypt	The central bank approved rules for a digital financial identity, and the Prosecution opened criminal-record self-enquiry through digital identity. Full record 2026-08-23 - the central bank's board approved rules for the digital financial identity system: customers may open accounts and take banking products through digital channels without visiting a branch, with electronic acceptance of terms and electronic authentication in place of a handwritten signature, the rules setting out governance, participants' roles, technical and operational requirements and data-protection and cybersecurity controls, the system having been launched in November 2025. No enrolment or verification volume is held. On the non-bank side, lending, investment and insurance companies may create digital identities, run biometric and non-biometric checks against national-identity and mobile-registry databases and execute binding electronic contracts, the licensee reporting over 25m verifications a year. 2026-07-27 - a citizen may now query criminal judgments registered against their own national number through the digital identity system, the Prosecution stating the result is not a substitute for official certificates.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Eswatini	The e-KYC registry is being built so banks and ministries can verify against one identity record, with 500,000 users targeted by 2028. Full record The central bank convened banks, financial-service providers and government ministries around a national identity-verification registry, with a cross-border dimension inside the regional bloc (registry). The FinTech Strategy 2025-2030 commits to it, targeting 500,000 users and 80 per cent interoperability by 2028 (strategy). Technical assistance is funded to connect the national system into a federated regional framework. Against the commitments, the credential itself does not qualify: the national identity card does not meet the criteria for digital identification, and no verification volume is published for any system.	Advanced
Ethiopia	All bank accounts were required to be harmonised with the identity by March 2026, and one bank now opens accounts on it alone. Full record The December 2025 directive required every bank account to be harmonised with the national identity by 30 March 2026 (banking integration). A commercial bank opened the first accounts on the identity alone in April 2026, without other documents (remote account opening). Nothing is held on compliance with the deadline: no share of accounts harmonised, no extension and no enforcement action is on the record.	Advanced
Ghana	The card is the sole identity document for financial onboarding at all regulated institutions, and it carries no payment function. Full record Revised central-bank guidance of January 2026 makes it primary and sole for onboarding, with biometric and liveness checks (banking guidance). Reports of an activated card wallet reachable through a mobile app and a short code circulated in early April 2026 and were denied by the issuing authority on 8 April, which stated the card has not been activated for financial transaction purposes and that discussions on future integration remain inconclusive (denial).	Advanced
Guinea	A biometric civil-service payroll audit confirmed about 130,000 of about 277,000 registered staff and reports 233bn GNF saved since 2024. Full record The system has been in use since 2024 with no audit result published before this one (audit). The saving is about US\$26.9m at the reported date and is the government's own claim (audit); no methodology, payroll series or independent verification is held, and the audit confirmed under half of those registered.	Advanced
Kenya	The High Court barred discontinuation of physical vehicle logbooks pending a petition on public participation and data-protection assessments. Full record The electronic system stands but cannot replace the paper one while the order holds; the petition argues it was introduced without public participation and without adequate data-protection and cybersecurity impact assessments (order). A compulsory digital seller identifier for electronic commerce was proposed by the trade ministry and is still a proposal with nothing on record being built (proposal).	Mixed, an electronic logbook was suspended by court order while a seller identifier remains a proposal

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Lesotho	The identity number is in use for customer verification across the financial sector, and cross-sector authentication is being formalised. Full record 2025-11-17 — the financial sector strategy is the most current statement of the identity number's linkage to the credit bureau, banks, insurers and mobile network operators. 2026-02-26 — the 2026 work plan formalises cross-sector authentication and financial-services identity verification. 2025-08-26 — a framework workshop set out identity-verified access to services, the earliest in-window statement of the design. What the base does not hold is a transaction figure: how often the identity is actually checked, by whom, and at what cost to the relying party.	Advanced
Liberia	Module registration was tied to the identity number with a July 2025 deadline, and no compliance figure or enforcement action has followed. Full record The deadline was set under an October 2024 memorandum between the telecoms regulator and the identity registry (memorandum). No revised deadline is published either, on a register whose issuance was halted for most of the period the deadline ran, so the requirement and the credential it requires were unavailable at the same time.	No change
Libya	The National ID Number gates SIM registration, passports, bank accounts, marriage and voting, and that position has not moved since 2024. Full record The number is in force and required across those services, which makes it the country's operative credential rather than one of several (gating). Nothing has been published since 2024 on how many transactions are gated on it, on which further systems have taken it up, or on what a resident without one can still obtain.	No change
Madagascar	The unique identifier was integrated into the household register and civil-servant enrolment by December 2025, with gaps outstanding. Full record A World Bank implementation-support mission of December 2025 records integration of the unique identifier and the biometric database into the household register, human-resources enrolment of civil servants and digitisation of a court records system, with integration gaps outstanding before the project's June 2026 closing date (mission). The law on identification of natural persons that underpins the use cleared constitutional review in August 2025 (decision). The mission report names the integrations; it does not state which are in production, and no transaction volume through any of them is held.	Advanced
Malawi	Mandatory biometric SIM registration authenticates against the identity system, and no completion figure, compliance rate or closure date is held. Full record The programme began in July 2025 with a registration window to September, run by the regulator with the registration bureau, allowing fewer than ten cards per person per operator and carrying non-compliance fines up to MWK 50,000 daily for individuals and MWK 150,000 for corporates (programme). The regulator and a development agency named integration of the identity system with SIM verification as a priority area still being explored in July 2026 (exploration), which sits awkwardly with a 2025 programme already authenticating against that system.	No change

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mali	The NINA national identity number is in use as the national identity key and authenticates applications to the justice e-services. Full record The number is the identity key on which the online criminal record and nationality certificate applications are made (number). No count of systems keyed on it, no authentication volume and no coverage share of the population holding one is published, so its reach into other systems is recorded by example and not by measure.	No change
Mauritania	Formal notices went to all three operators in January 2026 over biometric SIM identification, with a two-month deadline before sanctions of up to 3 per cent of turnover. Full record Deactivation of non-biometric cards had been ordered in October 2023 with compliance not established; formal notices with a two-month deadline followed in January 2026 (notices). No compliance outcome is on record. Three years between an order and a sanction threat, with no published measure of how many cards were affected either time, is the shape of enforcement here.	Advanced
Mauritius	SIM registration by electronic identity check has been in use since the re-registration exercise, with no completion or coverage figure held. Full record The electronic verification steps were published for the re-registration exercise and remain in use (steps). No completion or coverage figure is held, and no other system is recorded taking the national identity as its authentication, so the identity layer's reach into other sectors cannot be established from this base.	No change
Morocco	The national digital wallet binds five state bodies on a card-authenticated core, on eight partnership conventions signed in February 2026. Full record Eight conventions were signed in Rabat in February 2026 and two vendors engaged on architecture, on a stated six-month build (conventions, architecture). The bodies bound are the social security fund, the road safety agency, the land registry, transport, and youth and culture. No launch date, service count or user figure is held, so the base records which systems have agreed to take the identity and not one that has.	Advanced
Mozambique	Biometric SIM registration became compulsory in 2024 with blocking from 2025, and nothing has entered the base on the regime since. Full record Registration was optional from a pilot in January 2024, compulsory in the second half of that year and subject to blocking from 2025, as described at the time (regime). No later account is held and no registration, blocking or enforcement figures exist in the base at all. Nothing has entered it on this regime for over two years, which for a compulsory nationwide identity-linked measure is the notable fact.	No change
Namibia	The population register is read by social protection for beneficiary verification and by the payment network for the first government grant disbursements. Full record The home affairs ministry's annual report documents the register connected across its own offices and border posts (report). Outside the ministry, social protection verifies identity and live status against it, and uses it to identify and refer undocumented people (integration); the effect showed in June 2026 when 15,825 unverified old-age grants were suspended (suspension). The first live government grant payments ran over the national instant payment network in June 2026 through one certified bank (payment). Two systems read the register today: social protection and, through it, payments. No banking, tax or land system is recorded doing so.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Nigeria	A learner identification number was integrated with the identity register, farmer verification is planned on a subsidy taper, a credit bureau would key scores to the number, and pre-registered SIMs ended. Full record A sixteen-digit learner number issued from April 2026 reached 1.9m at launch and was integrated with the identity register across a stated 80m student records; birth registration is integrated so newly registered children receive a number automatically, yet school admission remains manual and the birth register is not connected to any state education platform, so the failure is interoperability rather than enrolment. The integration was announced on a social platform rather than in an instrument, and it makes school enrolment an enrolment channel for the identity register (learners, gap). A centralised farmers database would target subsidies on a three-year taper and remove ghost beneficiaries (farmers), and a proposed bureau would tie credit scores to the number with consequences for defaulters extending to passport and licence renewal and tenancy (credit). Pre-registered cards ended in November 2025 (cards).	Advanced
Rwanda	A biometric SIM registration regulation was issued in August 2024 and piloted the following month. Full record The regulation governs registration of subscriber cards and was piloted in September 2024 (regulation, pilot). Nothing on file records completion, coverage or a link to the digital identity register, so whether the two biometric captures are one enrolment or two is not established here.	No change
Sierra Leone	A national digital farmer registry was agreed for integration with the identity number in May 2025, and an agricultural voice-response platform is reported 98 per cent complete. Full record The registry integration was agreed with the agriculture ministry in May 2025 and has not moved since (registry). The voice-response platform is described as 98 per cent complete, which is the ministry's own description (platform); no launch date, language coverage, call volume or cost is stated (platform). Neither carries a data-protection arrangement, in a country with no data-protection law in force.	No change
Somalia	The credential was enforced at the main airport for inter-state travel from March 2026, and a legal analysis holds the proclamation behind it exceeds the Act, which confers a right and imposes no duty. Full record Enforcement began at the capital's airport in March 2026 (enforcement, overhaul). A published legal analysis holds that the presidential proclamation of September 2025 exceeds the identity statute, which confers a right to an identity credential and imposes no duty to obtain one. The two accounts have not been reconciled (analysis). Making a credential compulsory when about 2m of an estimated 19.7m people hold one is an exclusion question before it is a legal one, and no exception, appeal or alternative document route is published.	Mixed, the credential made compulsory for inter-state travel while a published legal analysis holds the proclamation exceeds the statute

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
South Africa	Home affairs built the Treasury a real-time biometric employee-verification portal against the population register, with go-live stated for June 2026. Full record 2026-05-26 — a real-time biometric employee-verification portal was built for the National Treasury and linked to the population register, to detect payroll records with no matching person, with go-live stated as 15 June 2026. No confirmation that go-live occurred, and no count of records checked or discrepancies found, is on file. It is the clearest case on this ledger of the identity layer being consumed by another department's system rather than by a bank, and it is priced: the verification service it runs on charges per query, reported under national maintenance. A payroll integrity check that costs the state money per employee is a design choice nothing on the record discusses.	Advanced
Tunisia	The national health identifier is the repurposed Covid-19 vaccination identifier, and a single social identifier was worked on at a ministerial session in August 2026. Full record The health identifier was confirmed as the repurposed vaccination identifier in July 2026; three counts circulate at three scopes and do not contradict each other, no national coverage figure has been published and no public dashboard exists (identifier, pilot, portal). The social identifier sits inside the health half of a wider social-security reform decision, on the government's own communique (social). Repurposing a pandemic identifier as the permanent health identifier is a decision about scope that no published instrument governs, which is the same gap the health dataset's missing legal basis names.	Advanced
Uganda	Seventy-four financial institutions had electronic verification access to the register as at June 2024, and a constitutional challenge to identity-based access was dismissed with each party bearing its own costs. Full record The institution count reaches the base through a central-bank annual report that is not itself held (institutions). The challenge was dismissed in June 2025; the case number is a specific miscellaneous cause, not the form circulated in secondary coverage (ruling, barrier). A dismissed challenge, a two-year-old institution count and a machine-readable code that does not work are the three things this base can say about the credential's use.	No change
Zambia	Passport and travel-document applications now require a national authentication account on the government service bus. Full record The Electronic Government Act, 2021 creates a citizen card as the cross-system identity and authentication credential. 2025-12 — the home affairs minister announced that passport, diplomatic passport, refugee travel document and identity travel document applications are integrated into the government service bus and require a national authentication account — the clearest live downstream use of the authentication service by another government system. 2026-01 — an agricultural input voucher ran electronic know-your-customer across all 116 districts, the largest-scale consumption of identity the base holds for the country.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Zimbabwe	A cotton farmer biometric registry was cleared to proceed on the model of a tobacco farmer identity registry for which the base holds no primary. Full record The marketing authority was cleared to proceed with field teams stated for October 2025; that date is the acting chief executive's stated intention rather than a confirmed start (cotton). The tobacco registry is cited as the model the cotton registry emulates, and the base holds no primary from the marketing board — only a secondary reference (tobacco). Biometric registration of farmers by commodity marketing boards, modelled on a system nobody has published anything about, in a country with no working national digital identity. A third farmer registry, run by a United Nations agency rather than a ministry, entered a second phase in October 2025 targeting 36,588 farmers across 12 districts in four provinces for the 2025/26 cropping season, with 14,915 registered by 30 October and completion expected in the first week of November (farmer registry). Three separate farmer registries on three separate applications is the pattern worth naming: each is built for the programme that funded it.	Advanced

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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